

Physical Education

Year 6

Cambridge Primary
Student Manual





Physical Education

Year 6 · Student Manual

The High Fields

A student book for Upper Primary, written for pupils of about ten to eleven years old. Year 3 stepped onto a measured track. Year 4 put the whole school on the sports day field at once. This year you go up the hill, through the five-bar gate, to the fields where the oldest ones work.

Six places on the high fields: the Five-Bar Gate, the Dry Stone Wall, the Orchard, the Hay Meadow, the Tack Room and the Hill Spring. Pip, Bramble, Sorrel, Tuft, Willow and Rowan are all here again, three years older, and this year they write the morning down before anybody moves.

Anybody can climb to the bar they already fit on. The interesting question is which bar you are working on, and whether you could say so out loud.

Physical Education · Year 6

Student Manual. First edition, 2026.

Prime Books is the publishing imprint of Prime School, Portugal.

www.primeschool.pt

© Prime School 2026. All rights reserved. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system or transmitted in any form or by any means without the prior written permission of the publisher.

Editorial Board. Pedagogical Academic Group · Pedagogical Team · Pedagogical Department · Content Creation Team.

Text, design and illustration. Written and designed by the Prime Books editorial studio. Original watercolour illustration produced for Prime School. All illustrations © Prime School 2026.

Safety, and it is not a formality. This is a Physical Education book, so almost every task moves a body through a space, and several tasks in this book ask a pupil to choose a harder version for themselves. Every task assumes a teacher present, a space checked before the lesson, and apparatus set out and tested by an adult. The teacher carries out their own risk assessment and follows the school's safety policy. Where a task carries a particular risk, the book says so on the page in a violet **Stay safe** panel. Those panels are instructions, not advice.

Square codes. Both square codes in this book were scanned, and both addresses answered correctly, when this edition went to press. An adult holds the device and opens the page. Pages outside Prime School's control may move or close, and Prime School is not responsible for their content.

Inclusion. Every comparison in this book asks a pupil to look at their own earlier attempt. No task ranks one pupil against another, and no task requires a particular body to succeed. Distances, heights, weights and timings are all adjustable, and the gates exist so that a pupil works at the bar they are actually on. The objective is control, not size.

British English throughout. Printed in Portugal on paper from responsibly managed forests.

About this book

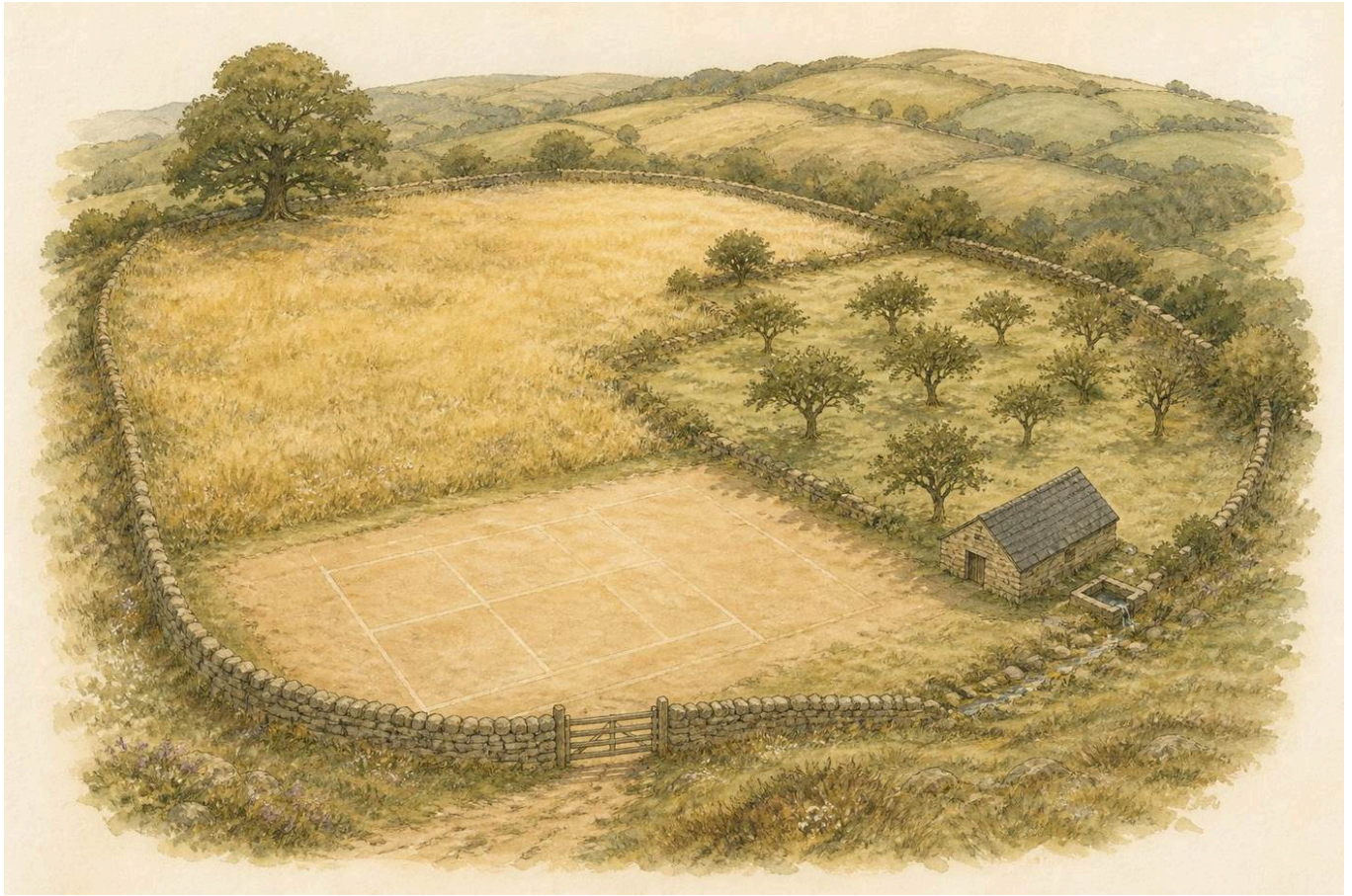
This is the Year 6 Physical Education student book in the Prime Books collection. It is written for pupils of about ten to eleven, and for the teachers and families who work with them.

Year 6 is the last primary year. The book consolidates the movement, teamwork and fair-play habits built from Year 1 to Year 5, and it prepares pupils for the extra independence of lower secondary Physical Education without turning into a secondary textbook.

On these pages pupils practise technique, coordination, agility, speed and endurance. They learn to use space, make decisions under a little pressure, talk clearly to a teammate, lead a short activity, and judge their own work. Fitness is taught through doing: warm-up, cool-down, how hard a task feels, water, rest, and the habit of being active most days. Sportsmanship is treated as a skill, not a poster.

Book description. *Physical Education Year 6: The High Fields* is the final primary title in the Prime Books Physical Education sequence. Six units take pupils through a five-bar gate, a dry stone wall, an orchard, a hay meadow, a tack room and a hill spring. They keep a broad range of skills in repair, name what they see, invent more than one answer, take a real role in a team, share kit fairly, and plan activity they can keep. The book is for the last year of primary school and for the first step towards the next one.

WHAT THIS YEAR BUILDS	WHAT THAT LOOKS LIKE ON THE FIELDS
Technique and control	A named detail, practised, then judged by a watcher
Fitness you can feel	Talk test, warm-up, cool-down, water, rest, a week not a burst
Tactics and decisions	Two plans, space, support, and a switch when the first plan stops
Teamwork and leadership	A role with a forbid, a deal written down, help that makes the next job easier
Responsibility	Kit shared and put away, fair play when the score matters, stop and tell an adult
Towards next year	A day sheet somebody else could run, and a goal you can test next lesson



The high fields from above. Six places, one year: the gate, the wall, the orchard, the hay meadow, the tack room and the spring. This is the last primary book in the line, and it is still the same countryside you have been walking since Year 1.

Contents

Every unit has its own colour, taken from the place on the high fields where it happens. The same colour runs through that whole unit, so you can find it with your thumb.

About this book	4
Up at the high fields	9
Your year, in three terms	11
Meet the six	13
How to use this book	14
Getting set up	16

1

Moving Well

The Five-Bar Gate

19

1.1 Keeping a broad range in repair	20
1.2 A wider variety, linked	27
1.3 Fluency, and how it is judged	34
1.4 Choosing your own task, and adapting live	41
Project The day you plan	46
Check How did it go?	50

2

Understanding Movement

The Dry Stone Wall

53

2.1 The words a sport actually uses	54
2.2 Action, dynamic, space, relationship	57
2.3 Writing the criteria, then marking against them	61
2.4 Rules, tactics, and having more than one plan	65
Project The criteria wall	70

3

Moving Creatively

The Orchard

74

3.1 Inventing in four different situations

75

3.2 Three answers, then choosing one

80

3.3 Setting yourself the problem

84

3.4 Composition that says something

88

Project The orchard show

92

Check How did the orchard go?

94

4

Taking Part

The Hay Meadow

96

4.1 Four ways of taking part

97

4.2 What a role actually commits you to

100

4.3 Your own next goal, in writing

104

4.4 Leading, and being led well

107

4.5 Using what you know about a body

111

4.6 Planning together without arguing

114

Project The meadow match

110

Check How did the meadow go?

120

5

Taking Responsibility

The Tack Room

122

5.1 Heavy kit, shared safely

123

5.2 Negotiating, not winning

126

5.3 Fair play when the score matters	130
5.4 Asking for help at the right moment	134
5.5 Feedback somebody can use	137
Project The tack-room morning	140
Check How did the tack room go?	142

6 **Healthy Bodies** 144

The Hill Spring

6.1 Why any of this matters	145
6.2 Naming the parts, and the components	149
6.3 How hard, and how do you know	153
6.4 Assessing a risk before you take it	157
6.5 Before, and afterwards	161
6.6 What a moving body needs to eat	165
Project The spring circuit	161
Check How did the spring go?	172

Words we used	174
----------------------	------------

Answers	177
----------------	------------

Sources	184
----------------	------------

For teachers	187
---------------------	------------



The high fields, before anybody walks up. The gate is shut and latched, the clay ground inside it has been swept, and there is still dew on the hay. Look past the wall: the orchard, the tack room and the spring are the other places in this book. Six places, six units.

Up at the high fields

You have been doing this subject for six years, so let us skip the part where somebody tells you that moving is good for you.

Here is what is actually different this year.

Up to now, a task arrived and you did it. The teacher set the distance, the teacher set the apparatus, and the teacher decided when it was hard enough. **This year you start setting some of that yourself**, and you find out that choosing well is a skill of its own, and a harder one than it looks.

That is why the fields at the top of the hill are the ones you have been walking past since Year 1 without going in.

The gate

Almost every task in this book comes as a **five-bar gate**, and each bar is the same task made harder.

You pick the bar you can hold today. You work on the one above it. And you say which bar you are on, out loud, before you go.

That sounds easy. It is not, and here is why.

WHAT MOST PEOPLE DO	WHAT THIS YEAR ASKS FOR
Pick the bar they already fit on, because it feels good	Pick the bar above it, because that is where anything changes
Pick the top bar, get it wrong, and stop	Pick a bar they can hold for a whole go, and then climb
Say "I did the hard one"	Say "I am on bar 3, and bar 4 fails at the turn"

The third row is the one this book is really about. By the end of Unit 1 you should be able to say, out loud and without being asked, exactly which version of a task you are working on and exactly where it goes wrong.

Four jobs, and you will do all of them

Almost every task needs more than one of you, because you cannot watch yourself move. The first three jobs came up the hill with you from Year 3. The fourth arrived in Year 4 and is the one that makes this subject honest.

JOB	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU MUST NOT DO
Mover	Do the movement, properly, as many times as the task says	Rush it to look quick, or quietly change the bar you said you were on
Timer	Count, or time, and say the number out loud	Guess, round the number kindly, or start the watch early
Watcher	Look at one thing only, and say what you saw	Say "good", which tells the mover nothing at all
Setter	Change the ground, or the task, while it is running	Change it to something dangerous, or change it to be funny

Swap jobs every time. The watcher's job is the one most people are worst at, and the setter's job is the one most people enjoy far too much.

And one thing before the jobs

New this year, and it is not a fifth job. It is something that happens **before** anybody moves.

THE DAY SHEET · PINNED TO THE GATEPOST BEFORE ANYBODY MOVES

MINUTES	PLACE	WHAT HAPPENS THERE	WHO
0-6	The hill lane	Warm up, walk then jog, twice up	Everybody
6-18	The clay ground	Gate 1.1, four goes each	Pip moves, Bramble times, Willow watches
18-30	The clay ground	Same gate, jobs rotate	Sorrel, Tuft, Rowan
30-35	The wall	Read the notes back, agree the next bar	Everybody

Thirty-five minutes, three places, six of us, and every one of them knows what they are doing before we get through the gate.

A group that writes the morning down looks slower for the first two minutes and then gets roughly twice as much done. A group that does not spends the lesson deciding, and the deciding happens standing still.

You will write one of these at the end of this unit, and it will be marked.

Your year, in three terms

Three terms, and each one finishes with a whole day of it. Those three days are where everything in this book gets used at once, and they are the only days of the year when the whole of Upper Primary is out on the fields together.

They are in the book this early on purpose. **You know the date, so you can work backwards from it.**

TERM 1

December

Athletics Day

- Sprint
- Relays
- Standing long jump
- Target throw
- Obstacle race

Five events, and four of them are things you audit in Unit 1.

TERM 2

March

Football Day

- Dribbling in and out of the cones
- Passing accuracy game
- Penalty shootout
- Full game

Every one of these needs you to adapt to other bodies, which is Topic 1.4.

TERM 3

June

Multi-sports Day

- Bowling
- Sack racing
- Bean bag throw
- Water pong

Four unlike skills in one morning. A broad range, tested.

How the three days connect to this book

THE DAY	WHAT IT ASKS OF YOU	WHERE YOU PRACTISE IT
Athletics Day Dec	A broad range of separate events, each done well once	1.1 Keeping a broad range in repair
Football Day Mar	Skills linked under pressure, with other bodies in the way	1.2 A wider variety, linked · 1.4 Adapting live
Multi-sports Day, Jun	Four skills that are nothing like each other , in one morning	1.1 the audit · 1.3 Fluency

Look at the middle column. Not one of those three days asks you to be good at one thing. Every one of them asks you to be **in working order across a range**, which is why this book opens with an audit instead of a race.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

There is a reason the dates are printed and not left vague.

A target with a date on it changes how people practise. If Athletics Day is on December _____ then a standing long jump that is rusty in September has about fourteen weeks to be repaired, and you can say how many of those weeks you have actually spent on it. A target with no date attached is a wish.

Work backwards from the date. It is the single most useful thing on this page.

Meet the six

The same six as always, three years older, and every one of them has a different problem this year.



Walking up to the gate together. Between them they are carrying the hoop, a rope and the ball, which is most of the kit list. Willow is the one flying, and she has brought nothing, because Willow is going to be watching.

Pip

Red squirrel, cream vest. Quick, and still the first to try anything. Last year he learned that his fastest attempt is not his best attempt. This year he has to learn something harder: that climbing to a bar he already fits on is not practice, it is a warm up.

Bramble

Badger, slate vest with cream trim. Strong and steady, and he never rushes. He holds the stopwatch and he reads out the number that is actually on it. This year he plans a morning and finds out he has written one only he could finish.

Sorrel

Brown hare, olive vest. The fastest of all of them, which mattered enormously in Year 3 and matters less every year since. This year she finds out that a Year 6 sequence is judged on fluency, and that being quick is not the same as being fluent.

Tuft

Hedgehog, rust vest. The smallest and the most careful. He reads a space before he moves into it, which is why he is almost never in anybody's way. This year he has to work on the things he has quietly stopped doing, not the ones he already feels safe at.

Willow



Barn owl. She watches, from the top of the gatepost where she can see the whole shape of a movement. She is the reason this book keeps asking you to say what you saw instead of saying whether you liked it.

This year her job grows. It is no longer enough to describe a movement accurately: she has to turn what she saw into a **success criterion**, a sentence somebody else could use to judge the same movement without her there. When you see her notes in a slate-grey panel, read *how* she says it, not only what she says.

Rowan

Otter, hedge-green vest. Happiest in a group and very good at giving everybody a job. This year he has to write the plan down so that it works when he is not standing there explaining it, and then take the least popular job himself.

None of the six is better than the others. Each one is good at a different thing, which is exactly how a class works, and it is why the tasks keep making you swap.

How to use this book

Every place on the high fields is built the same way, so once you know the shapes you always know where you are.

SHAPE	WHAT IT MEANS
Before you go up	A question to talk about before you move. There is no wrong answer yet.
What happened	The real problem for this topic. Everything after it is you sorting that out.
On these fields you will	What you will be able to do by the end. Come back and check.
Warm up	Two minutes, straight in, and it is never optional in this subject.
Do you remember?	Something from an earlier topic or an earlier year that you are about to need again.
Learn	The gate and the new idea. Read the drawing first, then the words.
Watch me try	One attempt, taken slowly, with the reason for each part.

SHAPE	WHAT IT MEANS
Try it another way	A second route to the same thing. Year 6 wants variety, not one method.
Your turn	Your work. Move first, then write, draw and tick in the book.
Willow's own notes	What a watcher actually wrote, and the criterion she turned it into.
Stay safe	Violet. An instruction, not a suggestion. Read it before you move.
The equipment you need	Fetch this before you start, so nobody stands about.
Did you know?	A true thing worth knowing that is not in any test.
Go a little further	For when you have finished and want more.
Climb a bar	Harder, on purpose. Expect to need three attempts.
The unit project	The last job of the unit. You plan it, then you run it.
The check	You judging your own work, honestly.
Look what I can do	The tick list. Only tick what is true today.
Words we used	Every new word, with its meaning.

The gates

Wherever you see a **five-bar gate** in the place colour, you are looking at one task written four or five times over, each bar harder than the bar below it.

- **Ring the bar you can hold today.** Not the one you managed once.
- **The bar above it is your work.** Write down where it goes wrong.
- **Nobody is on the same bar, and nobody needs to be.** Two of you on bar 2 and bar 4 of the same gate are doing the same lesson.

The other two drawings

DRAWING	WHAT IT SHOWS
A day sheet	A morning laid out in minutes: which place, what happens there, and who is doing it.
A marked ground	The swept clay ground seen from above, with white chalk on it, the way Willow sees it.

The chalk marks mean the same thing everywhere in the book, and they are the same marks you have been reading since Year 3.

MARK	MEANS
a solid white line	a line you may not cross
a dashed white line	the route a body travels
a white ring	where a body starts, or stops
a small cross	a cone, a marker or a spot
a dark disc	a body, at one moment
the ticks down the left edge	paces, counted

Writing in this book

You are meant to. The pale boxes, the ruled lines and the timing tables are yours. Use a pencil, because your second attempt is usually a different number from your first, and that is the whole point.

The square codes

Two pages carry a small square code. Each one opens a free page that gives you something this book cannot: a national guideline in its own words, and a real set of race results. **An adult holds the device and opens the page.** There is nothing in this book you cannot finish without one.

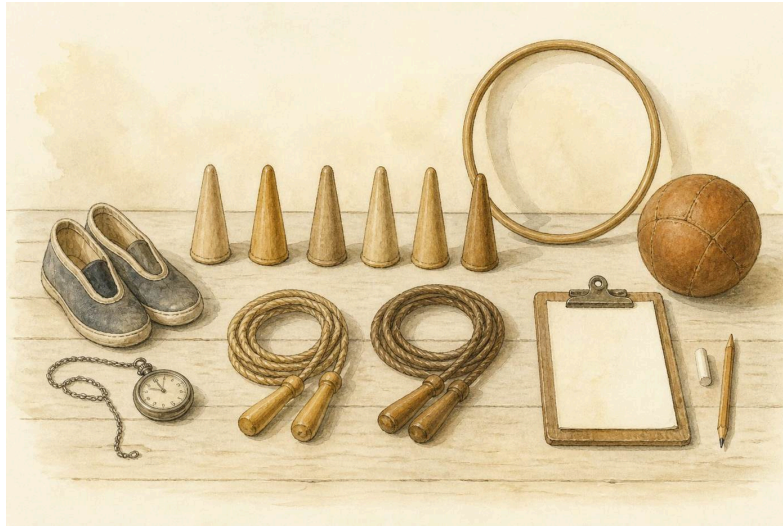
Getting set up

You do not need everything at once. Each place tells you what to fetch.

Your kit for the high fields

- soft indoor shoes, or bare feet, whichever your teacher says for the space
- a stopwatch, or one clock everybody can see
- six cones, or six of anything that stands up and does not roll away
- two skipping ropes
- a hoop
- one ball that bounces
- chalk, or a roll of low-tack tape, for marking a line on the ground

- a clipboard and a pencil, because a watcher who has to remember is a watcher who invents
- five other people, which is still the most important item on the list



Your kit, laid out. Not one thing here needs a screen. Count them against the list above: shoes, a stopwatch, six cones, two ropes, a hoop, a ball, a stub of chalk, a clipboard and a pencil. The clipboard does more work in Year 6 than it has ever done.

Ground rules

- 1 Walk up to the gate. Everybody walks, every time, however exciting it is.
- 2 Look before you move, and look again if somebody has changed the ground.
- 3 One mover at a time on a piece of apparatus, unless the task says otherwise.
- 4 The timer says the number that is on the watch, not the number that would be kind.
- 5 A watcher says what they **saw**, never whether it was good.
- 6 A setter changes the task, never the safety. If a change would make a task dangerous, the setter does not make it.
- 7 Say which bar you are on, out loud, before you go. Changing it quietly halfway through is the one thing in this book that counts as cheating.
- 8 Put the equipment back where it came from, at the end, without being asked.
- 9 Stop the moment you hear "stop". Not after this one. Now.
- 10 An adult holds the device for any square code.

+ STAY SAFE

Before anybody moves, check four things and say them out loud:

The ground. Dry, clear, nothing to trip on, nothing to slide on. **The edges.** Nothing hard within two paces of any line you might run past, and nobody working close to the wall. **The gate and the apparatus.** Every gate, bench, box and mat checked and tested by an adult, not by you. A gate is for climbing only when an adult says it is. **The plan.** Everybody knows which place they are going to and what happens there.

If any of the four is wrong, you tell an adult and you do not begin.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

Rule 7 is new this year, and it is worth knowing why it is in the list at all.

A gate only works if the bar is honest. A pupil who says "bar 4" and quietly does bar 2 has not gained anything: they have thrown away the one piece of information the whole method depends on, which is where their limit actually is. Nobody can help you at a level you are pretending to be on.

Saying "I am on bar 2" out loud, in front of five other people, is genuinely harder than doing bar 4 badly. That is why it is a rule and not a suggestion.

UNIT 1 · THE FIVE-BAR GATE

1

Moving well

You have a repertoire now. This unit is about keeping all of it in working order, linking pieces of it that are not alike, and holding a task you chose yourself while somebody else changes the ground under you.



✓ ON THESE FIELDS YOU WILL

- ① audit a broad range of your own skills, then repair the rustiest one rather than the favourite
- ② link four movements from three different families into one short sequence
- ③ say what separates **smooth** from **fluent**, and be judged on both
- ④ choose your own task and hold it while a setter and a second mover change the ground

△ BEFORE YOU GO UP

Name three things your body does well.

Now name the one it used to do well and has not done since about February.

Almost everybody has one. A skill you were good at, stopped using, and quietly lost. Nothing dramatic happened to it: you simply stopped spending time on it, and a skill you do not spend time on goes rusty in a way that is very hard to notice from the inside.

This unit starts there, because **consolidating a broad range** means keeping all of it in working order, and that is a completely different job from getting better at your best thing.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.1

Keeping a broad range in repair

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Two cones, chalk or tape for one line, a stopwatch or a wall clock, one clipboard and a pencil. Work in threes.

○ WARM UP

Walk briskly anywhere on the clay ground for one minute, changing direction whenever you meet somebody, without touching anybody. Then, on the spot: ten shoulder circles backwards, ten ankle rises, and five slow squats to about halfway down.

Now stand still. Your body is warm, your ankles and knees are awake, and you are ready. Cold practice is wasted practice, and at this age it is also how people hurt themselves.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From Getting set up, what does rule 7 ask you to do before you go?

And what does it call changing your bar quietly halfway through?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip is asked to spend twelve minutes practising.

He spends all twelve on his standing jump, which is already the best thing he does. By the end of it his standing jump is very slightly better and he is very pleased with himself.

Willow, who has been up on the gatepost with the clipboard, asks him to hop five times on his left foot. He wobbles on the second one and puts his other foot down on the fourth.

"When did you last do that?" she asks.

Pip cannot remember. That is the answer.

► Learn

You do not have one skill. You have a **repertoire**: a whole set of movements you can already perform, built up over six years.

A repertoire behaves like anything else you own. The parts you use stay in working order. The parts you stop using go rusty, and they go rusty silently, because nothing warns you about a skill you are not practising.

So Year 6 asks for a different kind of practice from Year 3. Not *refine my best movement*. **Keep a broad range in repair.**

Which means, before anything else, finding out what state the range is actually in. That is called an **audit**, and it takes one lesson.

A SKILL FAMILY

MOVEMENTS IN IT

Travelling

run, jog, skip, gallop, side-step, change direction

A SKILL FAMILY	MOVEMENTS IN IT
Leaving the ground	two-footed jump, hop, leap, land, take off from one foot
Turning	turn on the spot, turn while travelling, roll, spin
Balancing	hold still on a small base, on one foot, on a bench, on tiptoe
Sending and receiving	throw, catch, bounce, kick, strike, stop a ball

Five families. Almost everything you have learned since Year 1 sits in one of them, and most people have one family that has quietly stopped being practised.

The rule for this topic is short. Audit the range. Repair the rustiest. Leave your favourite alone for one lesson, because it does not need you.

GATE 1.1 · THE REPAIR GATE

- ① Practise your rustiest skill on your own. Ten goes. Nobody watching.
- ② Ten goes with a watcher looking at **one** named detail.
- ③ Ten goes, and you name the detail **before** you start, and it does not change once.
- ④ Ten goes, alternating with a **second** rusty skill, so neither one gets to stay warm.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and the timer records both, so you can see which of the two holds up under swapping.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it. Say which one out loud before you go.

Bar 4 is where most of this class will end up, and it is worth saying why it is harder than bar 3 rather than just longer. Alternating two skills stops your body settling into either one. That is uncomfortable, and it is also much closer to what a game or a gymnastics sequence actually demands of you.

► WATCH ME TRY

Pip does the audit properly. Willow holds the clipboard and they go through the five families, four goes at each movement.

FAMILY	MOVEMENT TRIED	WHAT WILLOW WROTE	STATE
travel	side-step, both ways	even both ways, feet never crossed	good
ground	two-footed jump and land	knees bent, hands still, no wobble	good
ground	hop, left foot, five times	wobbled on 2, other foot down on 4	rusty
turn	turn while travelling	slowed almost to a stop to turn	rusty
balance	one foot, count of ten	held it, arms working hard	nearly
send	bounce and catch, ten	ten from ten, no reaching	good

Pip has two rusty items and one nearly. He picks the **hop on his left foot**, because it failed earliest, and he names his one detail before he begins: *land on the front of the foot with the knee soft, and keep the other foot off the ground*.

Ten goes, Willow watching the raised foot and nothing else, Bramble counting the touch-downs.

GO	RAISED FOOT	TOUCH-DOWNS	WHAT PIP CHANGED NEXT
1	down on hop 4	2	nothing yet, that was the first one
3	down on hop 4	2	softer knee on landing
5	down on hop 5	1	keep the softer knee, look ahead
8	stayed up	0	nothing. Do that again.
10	stayed up	0	nothing. It is repaired, for today.

Notice the last column at goes 8 and 10. When something works you do **not** change it. You repeat it until it is the thing your body does without being asked.

And notice what Pip did not do. He did not spend the lesson on his standing jump, which was already good, and he did not try to fix the hop and the turn in the same twelve minutes.

♦ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Hop, left foot, go 1: other foot came down on hop 4, landing on the heel, knee locked straight.

Hop, left foot, go 10: other foot stayed up for all five, landing on the front of the foot, knee giving a little each time.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

the raised foot must not touch the ground, and each landing must be on the front of the foot with a visible bend in the knee.

That last line is new this year. It is not enough to describe what you saw accurately. Willow has turned her description into a **success criterion**: a sentence another pupil could use to judge the same hop, tomorrow, without her there. Unit 2 is built on that sentence, and it starts here.



The same hop, again and again, on purpose. The faint shapes behind Pip are his earlier goes: this is one skill being repaired, not six skills being sampled. Look at Willow, low down and very close in. She is watching the raised foot and nothing else, which is the one detail Pip named before he started.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

Naide Gomes competed for Portugal in two very different jobs.

In 2004 she won the world indoor **pentathlon** title in Budapest with 4,759 points. A pentathlon is five events in one competition: she had to hurdle, jump high, put a shot, jump long and run 800 metres, all in the same day, all to a decent standard.

A knee injury in 2005 ended her combined events career. From 2006 she was a long jumper and nothing else, and in 2008 she won the world indoor **long jump** title in Valencia with 7.00 metres. Her best ever jump, 7.12 metres in Monaco on 29 July 2008, is still the Portuguese record.

Read those two paragraphs together. She spent years keeping five events in working order at once, and then spent years refining one. Both are real training. This topic is the first job, and Year 3 was mostly the second.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Audit your range.** Four goes at one movement from each family. Your watcher writes what they saw. You write good, nearly, or rusty.

FAMILY	MOVEMENT I TRIED	WHAT THE WATCHER SAW	STATE
travel	_____	_____	_____
ground	_____	_____	_____
turn	_____	_____	_____
balance	_____	_____	_____
send	_____	_____	_____

- 2 Which one failed **earliest**?** That is your rustiest, and it is not necessarily the one that felt worst.

My rustiest skill is

- 3 Name your one detail before you start. It must be about a body part, and a watcher must be able to see it.

The one detail I will change is

- 4 Ten goes. Fill this in as you go.

GO	WHAT THE WATCHER SAW	COUNT
1	_____	_____
4	_____	_____
7	_____	_____
10	_____	_____

- 5 Which bar of the repair gate were you on? Ring one, and be honest: this is rule 7.

- ☐ Bar 1, on my own
- ☐ Bar 2, with a watcher
- ☐ Bar 3, detail named first and never changed
- ☐ Bar 4, two skills alternating
- ☐ Bar 5, two skills alternating and both timed

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap and run the whole audit on your watcher's range.

Then answer this out loud: were their rusty families the same as yours? In most classes they are not, and the reason is worth a minute of talking. People keep practising what they enjoy, and the family you have let go rusty is usually the family you were never especially good at.

☰ SCAN TO FIND OUT MORE · TWENTY-FOUR ONE-MINUTE CHALLENGES



Twenty-four **one-minute challenges** from the Youth Sport Trust, free to download, with a bronze, silver and gold target on each one and a sheet to write your scores on. Speed bounce, target throw, balance, skipping and plenty more.

Why it is here. Every challenge is built the way this topic is: you do it for sixty seconds, you write the number down, and the only score you are trying to beat is **your own last one**. Pick one from a family you have let go rusty and take it home.

AN ADULT OPENS THIS PAGE

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.2

A wider variety, linked

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Chalk or tape for two lines, six cones, one low wooden bar and one mat if your space has them. Work in threes.

○ WARM UP

Cross the clay ground and back four times, using a different skill family each time: travel, leave the ground, turn, balance. Any movement from the family will do, as long as it is a different family every crossing.

That is the warm up and it is also the point of this topic. Four families in one minute is easy. Four families joined together, with no stop, is what the rest of the page is about.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.1, name the five skill families.

♦ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel builds a sequence: run, sprint, run fast round a cone, sprint again.

"Four movements," she says. "No stops anywhere."

Willow looks at her clipboard. "Four movements from one family," she says.

"You have built a sequence out of running."

Sorrel starts to argue and then stops, because she knows Willow is right.

► Learn

In Year 3 a sequence meant **three movements joined so that there is no stop in the middle**, and the joins were the work.

Year 6 keeps all of that and adds one word. The scheme asks you to link a **wider variety** of movement skills. So a sequence is now judged on two separate things:

JUDGED ON	WHICH MEANS
The joins	Still. No stop, no extra step, no arm shooting out to save it.
The variety	How many different families the movements come from.

Sorrel's sequence has excellent joins and no variety at all. It scores well on one of the two and nothing on the other.

And there is a reason variety is harder than length. **The joins between unlike movements are genuinely more difficult**, because the end of a run and the start of a balance want completely different things from your body: a run wants speed, and a balance wants none. Joining a run to a sprint is easy because nothing has to change. Joining a run to a balance is the actual skill.

GATE 1.2 · THE LINKING GATE

- ① Two movements, **one** family, one join.
- ② Three movements, at least **two** families, two joins.
- ③ Four movements, at least **three** families, three joins.
- ④ As bar 3, and the sequence **finishes in a balance** you can hold to a count of three.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and you perform the whole thing **twice**, and a watcher cannot tell the two goes apart.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it. Bar 5 is Year 6 work, not a bonus.

► WATCH ME TRY

Sorrel rebuilds her sequence, and this time she picks families first and movements second.

Families chosen: travelling, leaving the ground, balancing. Three. **Movements:** run, leap from one foot, land, balance on one foot.

Attempt 1. She runs, leaps, lands, and puts her second foot straight down to steady herself. *Join 3 failed. The balance never happened.*

Attempt 2. She shortens the run so she arrives at the leap slower, lands with a deeper knee bend, and gets into the balance. She holds it for about one second and steps out of it. *Join 3 worked. The balance is not yet a balance.*

Attempt 3. Same run, same leap, and she lands with her arms already out sideways instead of bringing them out afterwards. *Three joins, and a balance held past three.*

Read attempt 2 again, because it is the useful one. **Slowing the run down made the whole sequence better.** Sorrel has spent three years learning that faster is better, and this is the first task that has ever paid her for going slower.

⇌ TRY IT ANOTHER WAY

There is a second route to bar 4, and some bodies find it much easier.

Instead of *run, leap, land, balance*, try *run, turn, slow, balance*: keep the travelling and the balance, and replace leaving the ground with turning. It is still three families, still four movements, still three joins.

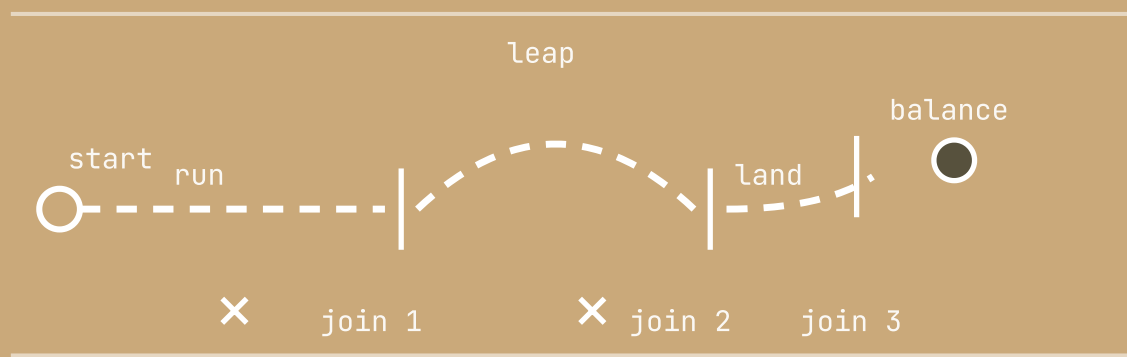
Why it can be easier: a turn lets you lose speed **gradually**, over a curve, whereas a leap gives you all your speed back at the moment you land and asks you to absorb it in one knee bend.

Do both. Then say which one your body prefers and why. Year 6 wants you to have more than one answer, not the right one.



The second route, and no leap in it. Read Sorrel left to right: a run, then one long banked curve round the cones, then a still balance. She loses her speed gradually all the way round the turn instead of taking it back in one knee bend. Same four movements, same three joins, and a completely different feel.

MARKED GROUND 1.2 · FOUR MOVEMENTS, THREE JOINS



The clay ground from above, chalked. The three short upright marks are the joins, and the only one that is genuinely difficult is join 3, where a body that is still travelling has to become a body that is completely still. The filled disc is the held balance. The two crosses are cones.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

A triathlon is three unlike movements in a row: at the standard Olympic distance, a 1.5 kilometre swim, a 40 kilometre ride and a 10 kilometre run.

The interesting part is how it is timed. A triathlon is timed in **five** sections, not three. Between the swim and the ride there is T1, and between the ride and the run there is T2, and World Triathlon publishes each of those as its own column in the results. As the rules put it, the time spent in transition is a timed segment and it counts towards the overall finishing time.

So the sport has decided, officially, that **the join is part of the event**. Two athletes can swim, ride and run at exactly the same speed, and the one who is better at the two joins wins.



Four movements, one continuous line. Read Sorrel left to right: the run is still going, the leap has already left the ground, and the last shape is arriving on one foot. Nothing in this picture has stopped, and nothing has put a second foot down to steady itself. Willow is on the gatepost, watching the joins rather than the movements.

• **YOUR TURN**

1 Choose your families first. Tick the ones your sequence will use. Bar 3 needs at least three ticks.

- ☐ travelling
- ☐ leaving the ground
- ☐ turning
- ☐ balancing
- ☐ sending and receiving

2 Now choose the movements, in order.

OUR SEQUENCE

1

2

3

4

Three joins. Mark each one with an arrow, and write the family beside each movement.

- 3 Run it three times. After each go the watcher names the **weakest join**, not the whole sequence.

GO	THE WEAKEST JOIN WAS	BECAUSE
1		
2		
3		

- 4 Chalk your sequence on the ground below, seen from above. Use a dashed line for the route, a ring for the start, a dark disc for a held position, and a short upright mark at each join.

OUR SEQUENCE, CHALKED FROM ABOVE

- 5 Tick every one that is true of your third go.
- ☐ Four movements, from at least three families.
 - ☐ No stop and no extra step at any join.
 - ☐ It finished in a balance I held to a count of three.
 - ☐ I could have performed it again immediately, the same way.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Perform your sequence twice, back to back, and ask a watcher who has not seen it before to write down **both** goes separately.

You pass when they cannot tell you which description belongs to which go.

If they can tell, do not explain. Find the movement where the two goes differed and practise that one, on its own, ten times.

≡ SCAN TO FIND OUT MORE · FIFTY MOVEMENTS, DEMONSTRATED



More than fifty activity cards from the Youth Sport Trust, free and with nothing to join, and **a short video of somebody doing each one**. Travelling, jumping, turning, balancing, throwing and catching: every family in this topic is in there.

Why it is here. You cannot link movements you have not got. Watch three you have never tried, learn one of them, and put it into your sequence next lesson. That is one more family, which is a whole bar on the gate.

AN ADULT OPENS THIS PAGE

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.3

Fluency, and how it is judged

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Chalk or tape for two lines, six cones, a drum or a tambourine if your teacher has one, a stopwatch and a clipboard. Work in threes.

◦ WARM UP

Cross the clay ground four times on your teacher's signal: once as fast as you safely can, once as slowly as you possibly can, once as tall as you can, and once as low as you can.

Then do it a fifth time and try to keep the **same rhythm** all the way across, at any speed you like. That fifth one is what this topic is about, and it is the one almost nobody gets right first time.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.2, a Year 6 sequence is judged on two separate things. Name both.

Which of the two did Sorrel score nothing on?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft performs his sequence. There are no stops in it anywhere. He gets to the end and looks quietly pleased.

"Smooth," says Pip.

"Not fluent," says Willow, and she reads back what she wrote. "Run, then a pause that was not quite a stop, then a very fast turn, then a slow careful balance. Four different speeds in one sequence and none of them chosen."

► Learn

Year 3 asked for **smooth**: no wasted wobble, no extra step, no arm shooting out to save it. You can hear that it is about the joins.

Year 6 asks for **fluent**, and it is a different word doing a different job.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS	WHERE YOU LOOK
Smooth	Nothing goes wrong at the joins	At each join

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS	WHERE YOU LOOK
Fluent	The whole thing has one rhythm, and it was chosen	At the whole sequence
Variety	The parts are genuinely different from each other	At the list of families

A sequence can be perfectly smooth and not fluent at all, which is exactly what Tuft's was. Every join worked. The rhythm changed four times, by accident.

So fluency is about the parts you are **not** looking at. It is the speed you hold between the joins, and it is the reason a performance can be technically correct and still look like four separate things stapled together.

The rule for this topic. Smooth is about the joins. Fluent is about the whole. Choose the rhythm before you start, and hold it.

GATE 1.3 · THE FLUENCY GATE

- ① Perform your 1.2 sequence with no stops.
- ② No stops, and no extra steps between movements.
- ③ No stops, no extra steps, and **one rhythm** held from start to finish.
- ④ Perform it twice at that rhythm, and a watcher cannot tell the goes apart.
- ⑤ Perform it once fast and once slow, **both** fluent, and still recognisably the same sequence.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 is the one that separates fluency from speed.

► WATCH ME TRY

Tuft does it again, and this time he chooses the rhythm before he moves.

"Slow," he says. "All of it. Count of four for every movement."

Bramble times each movement separately, which is the only way to see a rhythm.

GO	RUN	TURN	LEAP	BALANCE	WHAT WILLOW WROTE
1	3 s	1 s	1 s	5 s	four different speeds, not chosen
2	4 s	2 s	1 s	4 s	better, the leap still bolts
3	4 s	3 s	2 s	4 s	one rhythm, held all the way

Look at the leap column. It went from 1 second to 2 seconds, and that is the whole repair. A leap is the movement that most wants to be fast, so it is the movement that breaks a slow rhythm, and Tuft fixed it by taking a shorter run into it.

Now look at go 1 again. Nobody would have called that sequence badly performed. It had no stops in it. It was smooth, and it was not fluent, and until somebody timed each movement separately nobody could say why.

♦ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Go 1: run quick, turn snatched, leap fast, balance long and careful. Four speeds.

Go 3: run, turn, leap and balance all took about the same time. One speed the whole way. Arms moved at that speed too.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

time each movement separately. In a fluent sequence no movement takes less than half as long as the longest one.

That is a criterion you can hand to somebody with a stopwatch who has never seen the sequence, and they can apply it without you. Turning what you saw into a rule somebody else can use is the whole of Unit 2, and Willow is two topics early.



One crossing, three ways. The same chalk line and the same two cones run under all three. On the left Tuft goes fast and low. In the middle Sorrel goes slowly and very tall. On the right Bramble goes small and strong. Look at how much the shape of the body changes while the route does not change at all.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

Artistic gymnastics scores a routine with two numbers, and they measure exactly the two things this topic separates.

The **D score** is difficulty. It adds up the hardest elements, and it pays a bonus called **Composition Requirements** for using skills from the required element groups, worth 0.5 each up to 2.00. It pays a second bonus, **Connection Value**, for linking elements together. In other words, the D score pays for **variety** and for **joins**, which is Topic 1.2.

The **E score** is execution, and it works the other way round. Every routine starts at **10.0**, and judges take deductions off: 0.1 for a small error, 0.3 for a medium one, 0.5 for a large one, and 1.0 for a fall. Pausing between skills that were meant to be connected loses connection value.

So a gymnast is paid for variety and linking, and charged for everything that is not fluent. That is not a coincidence. It is the same judgement this unit is teaching you to make.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Perform your 1.2 sequence and have your timer time **each movement separately**. Do not choose a rhythm yet.

MOVEMENT	GO 1	GO 2	GO 3
1	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____
4	_____	_____	_____

- 2 Look down the Go 1 column. Which movement is the **shortest**? That is the one breaking your rhythm.

Movement _____ is breaking it.

- 3 Now choose a rhythm out loud, before you move, and perform it again. Write the rhythm you chose.

The rhythm I chose is

- 4 Apply Willow's criterion to your Go 3 column. In a fluent sequence, no movement takes less than **half** as long as the longest one. Does yours pass?
- ☐ Yes, every movement is at least half the longest.
- ☐ No, and the movement that fails is number _____
- 5 Score your own Go 3 the way gymnastics does, and be strict with yourself.

TAKE OFF	FOR	YOUR DEDUCTIONS
0.1	a small wobble, an arm that moved to help	_____
0.3	an extra step, a rhythm that changed once	_____
0.5	a clear pause where there should be a join	_____
1.0	a fall, or a foot put down in a balance	_____

Start at 10.0, take your deductions off, and write what is left.

My execution score is _____

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Perform your sequence at a rhythm your watcher chooses and does not tell you until you are on the start line.

This is much harder than choosing your own, and it is worth knowing why: you have practised your sequence at one speed, so all the small adjustments you have learned belong to that speed. A rhythm you did not choose takes those adjustments away.

UNIT 1 - TOPIC 1.4

Choosing your own task, and adapting live

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Six cones, one low bar, one mat, a stopwatch and a clipboard. If your space has a slope or a flight of low steps, and an adult has checked it, use it. **A teacher sets out and tests every piece of apparatus before the lesson begins.**

+ STAY SAFE

This topic puts two movers in one space and lets a third pupil change the task while they are moving. That is the point of it, and it is also the reason these four rules are not negotiable.

- 1 An adult sets out and tests every bar, box, mat and step. You never move apparatus into place yourself, and never while somebody is using it.
- 2 **The setter may change the task. The setter may never change the safety.** No change may send a mover into another body, off an edge, into the wall, or onto apparatus that was not set out for it.
- 3 Two movers share a space only when both of them have said out loud that they know the other one is there.
- 4 Any wobble at all in a bar, a box or a step: stop, step off, tell an adult. Do not test it again to see whether it does it twice.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.3, what is the difference between smooth and fluent?

Smooth is about _____ . Fluent is about

_____ .

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan has a sequence he is proud of, performed at a rhythm he chose, fluent from start to finish. He has practised it for two lessons on his own patch of clay.

Pip is made setter. Halfway through Rowan's run, Pip moves a cone into his line.

Rowan stops, thinks, goes round the outside of the cone, loses the leap completely, and arrives at the balance facing the wrong way.

"That was not fair," says Rowan.

"That was a lesson," says Willow, who is writing it down.

► Learn

Everything so far in this unit has happened in conditions you controlled. Your space, your rhythm, your sequence, nobody in the way.

Objective 1.4 asks for something else, and it asks for it in one long sentence worth reading slowly: apply movement competence with confidence in a variety of **self-selected** and more structured physical activities, showing the ability to respond and **adapt to changing contexts and to other people's movements, responses and roles**.

Two halves, and both are new.

The first half is that you choose. Nobody sets your task any more. You pick your bar off the gate, and the choosing is now part of the work. Choose too low and nothing happens. Choose too high and you spend the lesson failing at bar 5 instead of improving at bar 3.

The second half is that the conditions do not hold still. A setter changes the ground while you are working. Another mover shares your space and does not care about your plan. In a real game, both of those happen every few seconds.

WHEN THE GROUND CHANGES	KEEP	CHANGE
A setter changes the dynamic	the movements, the order, the joins	the speed, the level, the size, the force
A setter moves a marker	the movements, the rhythm	the direction, the pathway, where you finish

WHEN THE GROUND CHANGES	KEEP	CHANGE
Another mover takes your space	the sequence, the rhythm	your line, your timing, which side you pass

Read the **Keep** column again. Rowan lost his leap because he treated a moved cone as a new task instead of as one dial turned on the task he already had.

The rule for this topic. Keep the sequence. Change the one thing you were asked to change. Everything else stays exactly where it was.

GATE 1.4 · THE LIVE GATE

- ① You choose the sequence and perform it alone, on your own patch of clay.
- ② You choose it, and a setter changes **one dynamic** halfway through.
- ③ You choose it, and a setter **moves a marker** into your route halfway through.
- ④ You choose it, and a **second mover** shares the ground, so you adapt to a body, not a word.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and the setter changes the task for **both** movers at the same time.

You choose the bar. That is the whole point of this gate. Say which one out loud, and do not change it quietly.

► WATCH ME TRY

Rowan goes again, and this time he knows what adapting means.

Attempt 1. Pip moves a cone into the run. Rowan takes the run wider, keeps going, takes the leap from a little further out, and gets to the balance. *The leap was small and the balance wobbled, but the sequence survived. Nothing was abandoned.*

Attempt 2. Pip moves the cone earlier. Rowan takes the wider line and arrives late at the balance. *The sequence survived. The rhythm did not: the last two*

movements were rushed to catch up.

Attempt 3. Pip moves the cone earlier again. This time Rowan takes the wider line **and slows the run before it**, so he arrives at the leap with time to spare. *The sequence survived and so did the rhythm.*

Attempt 3 is the whole topic in one line. Rowan did not react faster. He **anticipated the cost** of the change and paid for it earlier in the sequence, which is what a Year 6 pupil can do and a Year 3 pupil cannot.



The setter, the mover and the body already on the path. Rowan is on the right with one arm up: he has just set a change. Sorrel is mid-stride on the path and has not stopped. Now look at the cone down by Tuft: that is the marker that moved, and Tuft is standing next to it, which means the change Sorrel actually has to make is not only the one that was set.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

Futsal is the version of football that is played indoors, and it is built to force exactly the adaptation this topic is about.

Five players a side on court, one of them the goalkeeper. A pitch of 40 metres by 20, which is small. Two periods of 20 minutes, and the clock **stops** at every dead ball, so almost all of the 40 minutes is played. And substitutions are unlimited and may be made **while the ball is in play**: a player comes off and another comes straight on without the game pausing.

Think about what that last rule does. The set of people you are playing with can change while you are in the middle of a movement, and nobody stops to tell you.

Portugal won the FIFA Futsal World Cup in Lithuania in 2021, beating Argentina by 2 goals to 1 in the final. It was Portugal's first title in the competition.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 **You choose.** Ring your bar on the live gate, and write it here before you move.

I am working on bar _____

- 2 Perform your sequence three times with a setter. The setter writes what they changed; you write what you kept and what you changed.

GO	WHAT THE SETTER CHANGED	WHAT I KEPT	WHAT I CHANGED
1	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____

- 3 Look at your **What I kept** column. If it is empty on any row, you started again instead of adapting. Write what you should have kept on that go.
- 4 Now add a second mover and run it twice more. Chalk the two routes on the grounds below: your line solid, theirs dashed, and a cross where you had to give way.

GO 1, TWO MOVERS, FROM ABOVE

GO 2, AFTER WE HAD TALKED ABOUT IT

- 5 Tick every one that is true of your last go.
- ☐ I kept the movements and the order.
 - ☐ I changed only the thing that was set.
 - ☐ I paid for the change earlier in the sequence instead of at the end.
 - ☐ The other mover and I never had to stop for each other.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Swap gates with another three, and perform **their** bar 4 rather than your own, from their written sequence only, with their setter setting.

Then tell them the one thing you had to change to make their sequence work on your body. It will not be the thing they change, and that is the interesting part: two bodies adapt the same sequence differently, and neither of them is doing it wrong.

The day you plan

Six of you, three places, thirty-five minutes, and this time nobody sets it up for you.

This is everything from the Five-Bar Gate at once. You will audit a range, build a sequence with real variety in it, make it fluent, choose your own bar, and hold all of it while somebody changes the ground. The difference is that **you write the morning down first, and the plan is marked as well as the moving.**



Before anybody moves. Six of them round one sheet of paper on the gatepost, and not one of them is warming up yet. Rowan is pointing at the row he is not happy with. The kit is already stacked and waiting, which is what a plan buys you.



A morning the six planned themselves. Willow and Rowan are at the day sheet pinned to the gatepost, which is where this project starts and where most of the marks are. Around them, three parts of the high fields are in use at once and nobody is standing about waiting to be told what to do.

THE DAY YOU PLAN · THE FIVE STEPS

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
1	Plan it. Fill in a day sheet: minutes, places, what happens there, who does what. Before anybody moves.	Could a group that has never met you run your morning from this sheet alone?
2	Audit and repair. Everybody names their rustiest family and works on it, at a bar they chose.	Did each person repair a rusty skill rather than polish a good one?
3	Build for variety. Four movements, at least three families, three joins, finishing in a held balance.	Count the families. Three or more, or bar 3 is not done.
4	Make it fluent. Choose a rhythm out loud. Timer times each movement separately. Apply the half-as-long criterion.	No movement shorter than half the longest one.
5	Run it live. A setter and a second mover. You keep the sequence and change only what was set.	Is the Keep column full on every go?

What good looks like: your sheet is still on the gatepost at the end of the morning with pencil all over it, and every one of the six can say which bar they were on.

Step 1 is the one that gets skipped, and skipping it is the most expensive mistake in this project. A group that plans on the way up the hill finishes all five steps. A group that plans on the clay finishes three of them and argues through the other two.



The two jobs that do the judging. Bramble has the watch up and his eye on it, and Willow has the clipboard, and both of them are looking at the same movement. Sorrel is the small figure away at the edge. In this picture the watchers are the subject, which is the point of step 4.

Our morning, written down before we move

OUR DAY SHEET

MINUTES	PLACE	WHAT HAPPENS THERE	WHO

Every row needs all four boxes filled. A row with no name on it is a row where six of you stand still.

OUR SEQUENCE, CHALKED BEFORE WE MOVED

WHAT THE WATCHER WROTE AFTERWARDS

♦ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Sheet: four rows, all four boxes filled, twelve minutes on the clay ground and only six at the wall, which was wrong because six of us cannot rotate through three jobs in six minutes.

Sequence: run, turn, leap, balance. Three families. Three joins, all clean on the second go.

Fluency: run 4 s, turn 3 s, leap 2 s, balance 4 s. Passes the half-as-long criterion.

Live: setter moved a cone at the turn. Sequence kept, rhythm kept, the leap got noticeably shorter and that was the cost.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

a day sheet passes when every row names a place, a task and a person, and when the minutes on each place are enough for everybody on that row to take every job once.

Read the first line again. Willow marked the **sheet**, not the moving, and she found the mistake in it. That is what this project is for.

How did it go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet. Answer for today, not for your best ever go.



The end of the morning, up on the wall. Everybody has their own sheet on their knees and nobody is comparing scores with anybody else. This is the part of the lesson that looks like nothing is happening, and it is where most of the learning gets written down.

AT THE FIVE-BAR GATE	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I audited a broad range of my own skills honestly	☐ ☐ ☐
I repaired my rustiest skill instead of polishing my best one	☐ ☐ ☐
My sequence used movements from at least three families	☐ ☐ ☐
I can say what separates smooth from fluent	☐ ☐ ☐
I chose a rhythm out loud and held it all the way through	☐ ☐ ☐
I chose my own bar, said which one, and did not change it quietly	☐ ☐ ☐
When the ground changed I kept the sequence and changed one thing	☐ ☐ ☐
Our day sheet could have been run by a group who had never met us	☐ ☐ ☐
As a watcher, I turned what I saw into a criterion somebody else could use	☐ ☐ ☐
As a setter, I changed the task and never the safety	☐ ☐ ☐

The last three rows are worth as much as the seven about moving. In Year 6 the watcher writes criteria, the setter holds a safety line, and whoever plans writes a sheet somebody else can read. Those are the jobs that make the moving worth anything, and they are the ones this year adds.

▪ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ audit a broad range of my own skills across five families, honestly
- ☐ name my rustiest skill and repair it with one named detail at a time
- ☐ build a sequence of four movements from at least three different families
- ☐ hold a balance at the end of a sequence to a count of three
- ☐ say what separates smooth from fluent, and which one my last go failed
- ☐ choose a rhythm before I move, and hold it from start to finish
- ☐ apply the half-as-long criterion to somebody else's sequence
- ☐ choose my own bar off a gate, say which one out loud, and stay on it
- ☐ keep a sequence and change only what a setter changed

- ☐ share a space with a second mover without either of us stopping
- ☐ write a day sheet another group could run without me
- ☐ turn something I watched into a success criterion somebody else can use

UNIT 2 · THE DRY STONE WALL

2

Understanding movement

You already know how to move. This unit is about naming what you see in the words the activity actually uses, writing criteria somebody else can mark against, and holding more than one plan when the first one is stopped.



✓ ON THESE FIELDS YOU WILL

- ① describe your own and other people's movements with the words the activity actually uses, and say which versions are more and less effective
- ② name an action, a dynamic, a space and a relationship in the same moment, and change one of them on purpose
- ③ write success criteria a pupil who was not standing next to you could mark against, then mark with them, then plan one improvement
- ④ follow the rules of a small-sided game, apply a tactic, and switch to a second plan you named before you started

△ BEFORE YOU GO UP

Year 5 refined one movement until it looked right. Year 6 names what it sees, writes a criterion somebody else can mark against, and keeps a second plan ready when the first one is stopped. The dry stone wall is where those sentences get pinned.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.1

The words a sport actually uses

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One size 4 football or a futsal ball, six cones, four bibs, clipboard and pencil. Work in fours: passer, runner, marker, watcher.

○ WARM UP

Jog the clay once, changing direction at every cone. Then ten gentle passes in pairs, along the ground. Freeze after the tenth and point to the space you passed into, not to the person.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From Unit 1, what job does a success criterion have to do?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip watches Rowan pass to Sorrel. "Good," he says.

Willow does not close the clipboard. "Good is a feeling. What did the ball do?"

"It went to Sorrel."

"Sorrel was standing still, and Bramble was already in front of her. Write that." Pip writes *to feet, marked*. That is the word doing its job.

► **Learn**

Every activity owns a small set of words. They name a fact a watcher can see.

ORDINARY	ACTIVITY WORD	WHAT MUST BE VISIBLE
good pass	pass into space	the ball arrives where the runner is going
nice touch	first touch	the first contact sets the next action
helping	support	a teammate is in a passing lane
getting close	close down	the marker shortens the space before the first touch
spread out	width	players hold the sides

A pass into space is **more effective** when the runner does not have to stop. The same kick, played at their feet while they are marked, is **less effective**, even if it was neat.

The rule for this topic. Use the word the activity owns. Then say whether that thing happened, or did not.

GATE 2.1 • THE WORD GATE

- ① Name one movement you just saw, in ordinary words.
- ② Replace that sentence with **one** activity-specific word.
- ③ Watch two goes and say which was **more effective**, using that word.
- ④ Write three activity-specific words, each about a different moment.
- ⑤ A new watcher marks the next go from those three words alone.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it.

► **WATCH ME TRY**

Rowan passes, Sorrel runs, Bramble marks. Pip may not write *good*.

GO	WHERE THE BALL ARRIVED	WORD	MORE OR LESS
1	at Sorrel's feet, Bramble already there	pass to feet, marked	less
2	one step ahead of Sorrel	pass into space	more
3	into space, but Sorrel had not started	pass into space, runner late	less

Go 3 is the useful one. Two facts, two bodies, no praise.



The pass is not aimed at the vest. Look at the gap Rowan is sending the ball into, one step ahead of Sorrel, then at Bramble: he is closing the player, not the space. The same kick is more or less effective depending on where it arrives, not on how hard it was struck.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Watch three passes. Write the **activity word**, not a feeling.

GO	ACTIVITY WORD	WHAT I SAW	MORE OR LESS?
1	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____

- 2 Compare your go 1 with your own go 3, not with anybody else's.

The thing that changed was

3 Write three words a **new** watcher could use, and ring your bar.

4 _____

5 _____

6 _____

I was on bar _____

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

Futsal is five players a side including the goalkeeper. Standard court about 40 m × 20 m. Two periods of 20 minutes with the clock stopped at every dead ball. On a court that size, a pass to feet into a crowd is not a style. It is a wasted touch.

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Watch a net-wall rally of four and try to use only football words on it. Write the sentence that failed, and replace it with a word that activity owns.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Hand your three words to a watcher who has not seen your group. If they ask what a word means, it is not finished. Cross it out.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.2

Action, dynamic, space, relationship

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A light bouncing ball, a rope an adult has hung as a net (or a line of cones), four cones for a small court, clipboard. Work in fours.

◦ WARM UP

Cross the court four times: slow, then fast and safe, then as wide as the cones allow, then in a pair so close you could talk. No ball yet. The fourth crossing is the one people bunch on.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 2.1, what is the difference between a pass into space and a pass to feet?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft sets four players for a net-wall rally. They stand in a polite clump, because that is where the ball is. The first send has nowhere to go.

Willow, from the wall: "Name the space you left empty." Nobody can, because they have not left any.

► Learn

One moment of movement is four things at once. Year 6 names all four.

WORD	THE QUESTION	FOOTBALL / FUTSAL	NET-WALL
Action	What did the body do?	pass, receive, close down	send, set, ready jump
Dynamic	How was it done?	firm along the ground	slow set, sudden send
Space	Where?	width, a gap to run into	along the net, empty back
Relationship	With or against whom?	passer and runner; one marker	setter and attacker; two covering

Creating space looks like a space job and is a relationship job. You make a gap by holding **width**, or by one player showing for the ball (**support**), so the marker cannot stand in both places.

The rule for this topic. Name all four. Then change one of them on purpose and keep the other three.

GATE 2.2 · THE FOUR-PART GATE

① Name the **action** only.

② Name the action and the **dynamic**.

③ Name action, dynamic and **space**.

④ Name all four: action, dynamic, space, **relationship**.

⑤ Change **one** of the four on purpose. A watcher says which one you changed.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it.

► WATCH ME TRY

Attempt 1, the clump. Action: send. Dynamic: hurried. Space: all four in the middle. Relationship: nobody covering. *No empty court.*

Attempt 2, width. Same action, slower dynamic. Two hold the sides, one stays back. Relationship: a setter, an attacker off one shoulder. *The send has a space, because the bodies made one first.*

↔ TRY IT ANOTHER WAY

Width is one way to make a space. **Depth** is the other: one player shows short, another stays high, so the marker has to choose near or far. Do four sends with each. If a watcher cannot tell them apart, you changed the word in the air and not on the court.



The empty bit is the subject of this picture. Two bodies hold the width, one is underneath ready to set, and the attacker is off the shoulder rather than on top of the setter. Look at the gap along the rope, not at the ball: that is the space the clump never made.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Freeze **one** moment. Fill all four.

WHAT I SAW

Action

Dynamic

Space

Relationship

- 2 Change **one** of the four on purpose. The watcher names which, without being told.

I changed _____ The watcher named _____

- 3 Chalk the freeze from above: discs for bodies, a ring for the empty space, a dashed line for the send.

ONE MOMENT, FROM ABOVE

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

Indoor volleyball is rally scored. A set is won by the first team to 25 points, and they must win by two. A deciding fifth set is to 15, still win by two. Every send is a point for someone. There is no spare rally in which the space can be vague.

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

On a freeze, point at the empty space **before** you speak. Then name the relationship that made it, or failed to. Do not point at the ball.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Bar 5, three changes running, watcher with only the four words. They must get all three. If they miss one, your change lived in your head.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.3

Writing the criteria, then marking against them

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Clipboards, pencils, four cones, one ball. A short performance to mark: three passes into space, or a net-wall rally of four. Work in threes: two movers, one watcher.

◦ WARM UP

Ten easy passes or sends, watcher swapping every fifth. The watcher writes one sentence per go and is not allowed *good*, *bad*, *nice* or *better*. If the pencil stops, the mover stops too.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

Name the four parts from 2.2.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel writes her improvement in large letters: be better.

Willow holds it up. "Who can mark that?" Nobody puts a hand up, including Sorrel. "Then it is not a plan. It is a mood. Pin a mood on the wall and the wall will not help you tomorrow."

► Learn

A **success criterion** is a sentence two watchers would mark the same way, without the mover explaining it. Then the improvement is **one** failed line, named, tried again, marked with the same paper.

WILL NOT DO

WILL DO, BECAUSE A STRANGER CAN SEE IT

be better

the ball arrives one step ahead of the runner

good communication

the passer calls the runner's name before the pass

try harder

the first touch goes in the direction of the next action

nice shape

both attackers hold the width of the cones

Three tests, and a line has to pass all of them: **visible** (a watcher can see it), **specific** (a body, a place, or a count), **stable** (two watchers, same go, same tick or same cross).

The rule for this topic. Write it so that you could leave the clipboard on the wall and walk away. Then mark against what you wrote, not against what you remember.

GATE 2.3 · THE CRITERIA GATE

- ① Write one criterion for your own go. Mark yourself against it.
- ② Write three criteria. A partner marks you against them.
- ③ A pupil who was not in your group marks you from the paper only.
- ④ Write one improvement. Same watcher, same criteria, one more go.
- ⑤ Swap papers. Their criteria must be clear enough to mark a go you have never seen practised.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it.

► WATCH ME TRY

Willow pins three lines for Rowan: call the name before the ball leaves; arrive one step ahead; first touch goes forward.

GO	CALL	INTO SPACE	TOUCH FORWARD	NEXT CHANGE
1	cross	cross	tick	look up, then pass
2	tick	cross	tick	pass earlier, while the runner is still moving
3	tick	tick	tick	nothing. Repeat this one.

After go 1 the job was criterion 1, failed. After go 2, criterion 1 was holding, so Rowan stopped spending attention on it.

♦ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Go 1: no call, ball to feet, first touch poked forward anyway.

Go 3: name called, ball one step ahead. Same three ticks from me and from Bramble, who had only the paper.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

two watchers, same clipboard, must tick or cross the same boxes without talking. If they disagree, the sentence comes off the wall until it is rewritten.



The clipboard is doing the judging, not the owl's memory. Willow is ticking and crossing three lines already written, and she is not looking up to see whether she likes the pass. Look at the paper first: if you cannot read the criterion from here, Rowan could not have used it either.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write three criteria for **one** activity you will do this lesson. Each must pass the three tests.

CRITERION (VISIBLE, SPECIFIC, STABLE)

1

2

3

2 Three goes. The watcher marks the paper, not their memory.

GO	1	2	3	THE ONE I WILL CHANGE NEXT
1	_____	_____	_____	
2	_____	_____	_____	
3	_____	_____	_____	

3 The **one** improvement you take into go 3, copied from a failed box.

The change is

I was on bar _____

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap clipboards with a group on a different activity. Mark one of their goes from their paper only. If you have to ask what a line means, write *not stable* beside it and give it back.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Bar 5: add a fourth criterion that names a **relationship** (support, mark, cover), not an action. Find out whether two watchers still agree.

UNIT 2 - TOPIC 2.4

Rules, tactics, and having more than one plan

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One ball, eight cones, bibs in two colours, clipboards. An adult marks a small rectangle. Play **3v2**, or 4v4 if the class divides evenly. One extra pupil watches, with the criteria from 2.3 in hand.

+ STAY SAFE

A small-sided game with marking. These four are not negotiable.

- 1 Mark with your **position**, never with hands on the player.
- 2 No sliding in, and no charging through a body to get to the ball.
- 3 Call the ball (*mine*, or the person's name) so two teammates do not arrive at the same time.
- 4 The rectangle stays the rectangle. A ball out is a ball out. You do not invent a rule in the last second because it would have helped.

○ WARM UP

3v0 at walking pace: five passes with width, then switch. Then 3v1, still walking. Speed is how people forget the call and the width together.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

What three tests does a criterion have to pass before it can sit on the wall?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan's three stretch wide, pass into space, shoot. It works twice. Then Tuft and Bramble stand where the wide player wants to run. Rowan keeps playing Plan A. They do not score again.

"They cheated," says Pip.

"They marked," says Willow. "When did you decide you were not allowed a second plan?"

► Learn

Three words, and Year 6 has to keep them apart.

WORD	WHAT IT IS	ON THIS RECTANGLE
Rule	both sides must do it, or it is not the same game	mark with position; ball out is out
Tactic	a way of using the rules to make a score more likely	3v2 with width , so one attacker is free
Plan	the tactic you start with, and the one you switch to	Plan A: stretch wide. Plan B: two short, then switch

Year 5 could apply one idea. Year 6 holds **more than one**. The same job exists away from a game: **variety in compositional ideas** means the same four movements arranged a second way. A sequence with only one arrangement is Plan A with no Plan B.

The rule for this topic. Name Plan A and Plan B before anybody moves. When A is stopped, switch. Do not invent B in a panic.

GATE 2.4 • THE SECOND-PLAN GATE

- ① Play and name the one **rule** you had to remember.
- ② Play with one named **tactic** (width, or short then switch).
- ③ Start on Plan A. When it is stopped, switch to Plan B, named first.
- ④ As bar 3, and everybody on your side can say which plan you are on.
- ⑤ Write a Plan C you did not use, and the moment you would have switched to it.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it.

► WATCH ME TRY

Plan A. Stretch wide. Pass into the space on the open side. **Plan B.** Two short passes in the middle, then switch.

Go 1: Plan A works. Tuft is late. Shot. Go 2: both defenders go wide. Rowan keeps feeding the same side. *A is stopped and they have not switched.* Go 3: Rowan calls "B" out loud. Two short, then the switch. Shot.

A plan that only one person knows is still only in that person's head.

↔ TRY IT ANOTHER WAY

If width is always your Plan A, make **depth** your A for one game: one attacker shows short, one stays high, the third is the switch. A watcher should be able to say, from the first three passes, which idea you started on.



Three against two, and the empty player is the point. Two attackers have taken the width, one is late showing short, and the two markers cannot be in all three places. Look at the free vest on the far side, then at Rowan: he has just seen Plan A stop and has not yet called B.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Before you play, write the rule, Plan A, and Plan B.

The rule we will not break is

Plan A:

Plan B:

- 2 Three goes of 3v2 (or two short net-wall games, same job). The watcher writes which plan they could see.

GO

PLAN THE WATCHER SAW

DID WE SWITCH? WHY / WHY NOT

1

2

3

- 3 Chalk both plans from above. Discs for bodies, dashed for the first pass, a ring for the free player.

PLAN A, FROM ABOVE

PLAN B, FROM ABOVE

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

In 11-a-side football a player is offside if, at the moment the ball is played by a teammate, they are in the opponents' half and nearer the opponents' goal line than both the ball and the second-last opponent.

You will not play 11-a-side with that law in this lesson. The sentence is here because it is a **rule that exists to block a tactic**: standing next to the goalkeeper and waiting. Name the rule before you name Plan A.

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

After the third go, the watcher reads the table out loud. Movers may not argue with **Plan the watcher saw**. If it does not match what you thought you were doing, write the call you should have used.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Bar 5, and Plan C must be a **different family of idea**, not a slightly wider Plan A: a set play from a restart, for example. Name the moment you would switch. If you cannot name the moment, it is not a plan yet.

The criteria wall

Six of you, one stretch of wall, and a short activity the other group has not seen you practise. The wall does the judging. If a sentence cannot sit on the stone and still make sense, it comes down and gets rewritten before anybody plays.



The wall is the teacher for this morning. Clipboards are already on the stones, and nobody is playing yet. Look at who is pointing at a line and who is shaking their head: that disagreement is the work, and it has to be finished before the ball is allowed to move.

THE CRITERIA WALL · THE FIVE STEPS

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
1	Write four criteria for one activity: passing into space, a net-wall rally of four, or 3v2. Pin them. No ball yet.	Each line passes visible, specific, stable. Activity words, not feelings.
2	Name Plan A and Plan B on the same wall, in two more lines.	A watcher can say which plan you started on from the first three actions.

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
3	Another group plays. You mark against the wall, not against your memory. No talking during the go.	Two of you mark the same go. Disagreements are written, not argued.
4	Hand them one improvement , copied from a failed box. They play once more. You mark the same four lines.	The improvement names one criterion, not a mood.
5	Swap. You play, they mark you from their wall. Then rewrite the one line two watchers disagreed on.	The rewritten line can be marked by a group that was not there for the argument.

What good looks like: four criteria still on the wall at the end, one of them rewritten in a different pencil, and every one of the six can say which plan they were on.

Our wall, written before we play

FOUR CRITERIA, THEN TWO PLANS

THE SENTENCE ON THE WALL	
C1	_____
C2	_____
C3	_____
C4	_____
Plan A	_____
Plan B	_____

If two watchers already disagree while you are writing, the line is not ready to pin.

♦ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Wall: three criteria about the pass, one about the call. Plan A width, Plan B short then switch. The fourth line said "work together", which Bramble and I already marked differently, so it came down before the first go. Their improvement named C2, not a feeling. Second go, C2 ticked.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

a wall passes when two watchers can mark the same go from it without talking, and when Plan A and Plan B are written in a different pencil from the criteria, so nobody confuses a tactic with a rule.

How did the wall go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet. Answer for today, not for your best ever sentence.

AT THE DRY STONE WALL	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I used activity-specific words instead of <i>good</i> and <i>nice</i>	☐ ☐ ☐
I could say which of two goes was more effective, and why	☐ ☐ ☐
I named action, dynamic, space and relationship in the same moment	☐ ☐ ☐
I changed one of those four on purpose and a watcher could say which	☐ ☐ ☐
My criteria were visible, specific and stable enough for a stranger to mark	☐ ☐ ☐
I marked against the paper, not against my memory	☐ ☐ ☐
My improvement named one failed criterion, not a mood	☐ ☐ ☐
I followed a rule I could explain, and I did not invent one at the end	☐ ☐ ☐
I started on Plan A and switched to a named Plan B when A was stopped	☐ ☐ ☐
Our wall could have been used by a group who had never met us	☐ ☐ ☐

A tactic you cannot name is just whatever happened. A criterion you cannot pin is just an opinion. The wall is there so neither of those can hide.

▪ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ describe a movement with the words the activity actually uses, not with *good*
- ☐ say which of two goes was more effective, and name the fact that made it so
- ☐ name an action, a dynamic, a space and a relationship in the same moment
- ☐ create space on purpose by width or by depth, and say which one I chose
- ☐ write a success criterion that is visible, specific and stable
- ☐ mark my own and somebody else's performance against written criteria
- ☐ plan one improvement copied from a failed box, then try it
- ☐ follow a small-sided rule because I can say why the rule is there
- ☐ apply a tactic in 3v2 or net-wall, and communicate it out loud
- ☐ name Plan A and Plan B before we start, and switch when A is stopped
- ☐ pin four criteria on the wall that another group can mark from without me
- ☐ rewrite a line two watchers disagreed on, until they mark it the same way

UNIT 3 • THE ORCHARD

3

Moving creatively

Inventing is the easy half. This unit is about inventing on purpose for the situation you are in, choosing one answer out of several, and making that choice so clear that a watcher can name it without being told.



✓ ON THESE FIELDS YOU WILL

- ① invent one idea, then remake it for four different situations
- ② find three answers to one challenge, choose one, and make the choice readable
- ③ write your own movement problem with a real constraint, then solve it
- ④ compose a short phrase so a watcher can name the theme, mood or emotion

▲ BEFORE YOU GO UP

Name a movement you made up last year that you were rather proud of. Now say what it was **for**. A race? A matching pair? A feeling? A problem somebody set?

If you cannot say, it was not an invention. It was a fidget that happened to look new. The orchard lane is narrow, and there is always somebody already in it. An idea that works when you are alone will fail when Rowan is coming the other way, and an idea that wins a race will not show a mood.

Year 6 creativity is three jobs, in this order: **invent, then choose, then make the choice readable to a watcher.**

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.1

Inventing in four different situations

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Six cones or six windfalls that will sit still, chalk or tape for one lane between two trees, a clipboard and a pencil. Work in threes.

○ WARM UP

Walk the orchard lane and back four times. First: on your own. Second: matching a partner, same feet, same count. Third: first to the last tree, no contact. Fourth: travel as if you are trying not to wake somebody. Four situations, one lane.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From Unit 1, a Year 6 sequence is judged on two separate things. Name both.

What must you keep when a setter changes the ground?

♦ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip invents a phrase under the first tree: skip, hop, still. Rowan joins him. They skip on different feet and arrive at the still on different counts. "Now make it a race," says Sorrel. Pip only goes faster. Rowan shortens the skip and arrives first. Willow writes one line. Same three movements. No situation named. I cannot tell what it was for.

► Learn

The scheme asks for creativity in **individual, group, expressive, competitive** and **cooperative** work. This topic treats that as four situations you can stand in:

SITUATION	THE INVENTION ONLY WORKS IF
Individual	one body can hold it, alone, with nobody to copy
Cooperative	two or more bodies finish it together , and it would fail if one dropped out
Competitive	the same idea is used to get there first , without contact
Expressive	a watcher can name a feeling from the movement, without a title

A skip that only gets quicker is not a new invention. It is the old one with the speed dial turned.

The rule. Name the situation first. Then invent. If a watcher cannot tell which situation you were in, you have not invented for it.

GATE 3.1 • THE SITUATION GATE

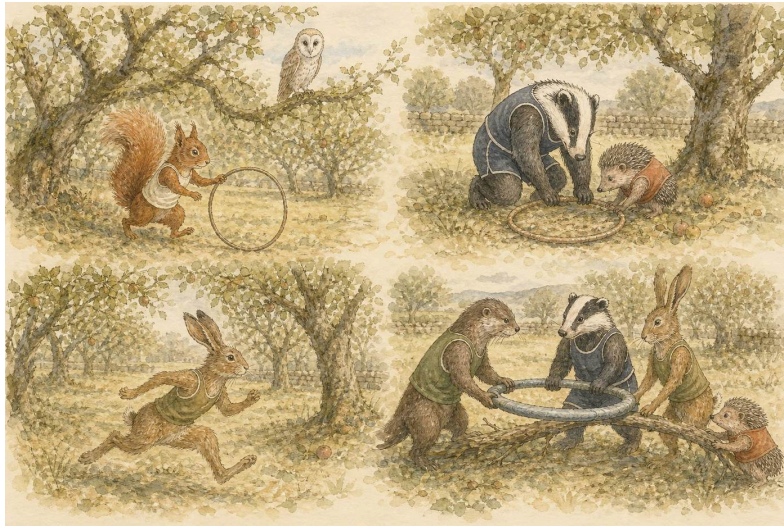
- ① Invent one short phrase and perform it alone.
- ② Remake it so two of you finish together, without talking.
- ③ Remake it as a race to a marker, with no contact and no extra steps.
- ④ Remake it so a watcher can name one mood from a list of four.
- ⑤ The same phrase, two of the four situations, and a watcher can say which is which.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it.

► WATCH ME TRY

Pip keeps skip, hop, still. He changes only what the situation demands.

Cooperative. They add a two-handed touch on the still, on the same count. If one of them is late, the phrase cannot finish. **Competitive.** Same three movements, plus a change of direction at the last tree. The race is about the line, not who can sprint the skip. **Expressive.** Same three movements, the hop almost to a stop. Willow writes *careful*, which was the word they had chosen. The touch is not decoration. **It is the thing that makes the situation true.**



Four situations, one invention remade. Pip is alone on the left. The same skip-hop-still is then a matching pair, then a race to the last tree. Look at Willow: she is watching which situation they are actually in, not whether the hop is neat.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

The **corridinho** is a traditional circling folk dance from the Algarve in southern Portugal. People travel on a curve, together, facing in. That is already a situation: a group, cooperative, circling. You cannot invent a corridinho as a race to a marker. The circle would break.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Invent one phrase of three or four movements. Write it once. Then remake it for two more situations.

SITUATION	WHAT I KEPT	WHAT I CHANGED, AND WHY THAT MAKES THE SITUATION TRUE

- 2 Your watcher names the situation of each remake, from the four words, without being told. They named

and

- 3 Ring the bar you held. If the watcher named the wrong situation, you are not on bar 5.

- ☐ Bar 1, alone
- ☐ Bar 2, finish together
- ☐ Bar 3, a race with no contact
- ☐ Bar 4, a mood a watcher can name
- ☐ Bar 5, two situations, both readable

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap phrases with another three. Remake **their** invention for a situation they did not use, then tell them the one thing you had to add to make the situation true. It will not be a faster skip.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

The same phrase in all four situations, one after another. A watcher writes four words. You pass when all four words are the four situations, in the right order.

+ STAY SAFE

Competitive versions in this orchard are a race to a marker, never a race through a body. No contact, no push, no trip. Both movers say out loud that they can see the other one before the race starts. The trees are scenery: nobody climbs them, and nobody hangs from a branch.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.2

Three answers, then choosing one

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Chalk or tape for one puddle in the lane, two cones as the first tree and the third, one hoop, a stopwatch, a clipboard. Work in threes.

○ WARM UP

Cross from the first tree to the third three times. First: over the chalk puddle. Second: around it. Third: up to the edge, still, then a careful step past. Do not decide which you like yet. The warm up is the three answers. Choosing is the lesson.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

Name the four situations from 3.1.

If a watcher cannot tell which situation you were in, what has gone wrong?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft is given one challenge: get from the first tree to the third without stepping on the chalk puddle. He invents a two-footed leap and likes it. Then, on the go that is supposed to be the chosen one, he leaps and adds a long curve afterwards, "to be safe". Willow writes: I saw two answers. I cannot tell which he chose. The watcher is not there to hear the explanation. The watcher is there to see the choice.

► **Learn**

Objective 3.2 is three verbs, and the middle one is the Year 6 one: **investigate, select and design**. Year 3 was happy with one clever way across a gap. Year 6 wants three answers that are genuinely different, then **one** of them performed so clearly that a watcher can name which of the three it was. Different does not mean faster. Different means a different **family**, or a different pathway.

ANSWER	FAMILY	WHAT IT DOES WITH THE PUDDLE
A	leaving the ground	goes over it
B	travelling	goes around it, on a curve
C	balancing	goes to the edge, holds still, then steps past

If your three answers are leap, bigger leap, and leap with a shout, you have investigated nothing.

The rule. Three answers. Choose one out loud. Perform only that one. If the watcher names a different answer, you did not choose. You stacked.

GATE 3.2 • THE CHOOSING GATE

- ① Invent one answer to a set challenge and perform it.
- ② Invent a second answer that is not the first one made faster.
- ③ Invent a third, from a different skill family.
- ④ Choose one, say why, and a watcher can name which of the three it was.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and a second mover uses a different chosen answer in the same lane without colliding.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it.

► **WATCH ME TRY**

Tuft writes his three answers before he moves again. **A.** Two-footed leap over the puddle, land, still. **B.** Long curve around the hoop-side of the lane, no pause. **C.**

Walk to the edge, balance on one foot to a count of three, step past. He likes A. He **chooses B**, because he can hold the curve, and he says so. **Attempt 1.** He starts the curve and then leaps at the end anyway. *Watcher names A. Choice failed.* **Attempt 2.** Curve only, same speed all the way, still at the third tree. *Watcher names B.* People keep a spare answer in their pocket and spend it mid-phrase. **A chosen answer has nothing left in the pocket.**



Three answers chalked under the same two trees. Tuft's leap, his long curve and his freeze-and-step sit on one patch of grass. Only one of them is ringed. That ring is the work: the other two stay on the ground.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

Women's artistic gymnastics floor exercises have a maximum time of **90 seconds**. Three full answers will not fit. The sport has already decided what this topic is about: invent more than you will use, then choose, then perform the choice cleanly inside the time you actually have.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 One challenge, written here before you move: *cross from cone to cone without touching the hoop*. Invent three answers from three different families.

FAMILY	THE ANSWER, IN ORDER
A _____	_____
B _____	_____

FAMILY

THE ANSWER, IN ORDER

C

2 Choose one. Write why. Then perform only that one. The watcher names A, B or C.

I chose _____ because

The watcher named _____

3 Ring the bar you held.

- ☐ Bar 1, one answer
- ☐ Bar 2, two answers, genuinely different
- ☐ Bar 3, three families
- ☐ Bar 4, the watcher named the one I chose
- ☐ Bar 5, two chosen answers, one lane, no collision

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

A setter changes the hoop after you have chosen: bigger, smaller, or moved one step. You keep the **chosen answer**. You change only the line. If you switch to a different letter, you started again. I kept _____

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Choose the answer you like **least**, and make that one readable. You pass when the watcher names it, and when you can say why it was harder to hold than the one you liked.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.3

Setting yourself the problem

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One hoop, one rope, six cones, one mat if an adult has set it out, a clipboard and a pencil. Work in threes. **An adult checks every piece of kit before the lesson begins.**

+ STAY SAFE

You may set the problem. You may not set the safety. An adult sets out and tests every hoop, rope, mat and cone. No climbing trees, no hanging from branches, no jumping off a bench you placed yourself. A problem that sends a mover into another body, off an edge, or into a trunk is not a harder problem: tear it up and write it again. If two of you share the lane, both say out loud that they can see the other one.

○ WARM UP

Solve this given problem, once each: *four movements, finish still, use the hoop once, no talking*. Then stand still. That was a problem somebody else wrote. The rest of the page is you writing the next one.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

After you have invented three answers, what is the next job?

How does a watcher know you chose, rather than stacked?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel writes a problem for the group: make a good sequence. Rowan reads it twice and does not start, because there is nothing to fail at. Bramble writes underneath: Four movements. Use the hoop once. Finish in a balance held to a count of three. No talking. They can start immediately. Sorrel looks at her own sentence and sees that it was not a problem. It was a wish.

► Learn

Objective 3.3 asks you to address **given** tasks and **self-directed** ones, and to find solutions through innovative use of movement. A given task is the hoop problem in the warm up: the book wrote the constraint. A self-directed task is one **you** write, and it is only a task if it has a constraint a partner could fail. "Do something interesting" cannot be failed, so it cannot be solved.

KIND	WHO WRITES THE CONSTRAINT	WHAT GOOD LOOKS LIKE
Given	the book, or the teacher	you solve what was written, not a nearby easier thing
Self-directed	you	a partner can start from the paper, without you talking

Innovative does not mean wild. It means the solution uses movement in a way the constraint did not already name. If the problem says *use the hoop*, stepping over it is ordinary. Landing **inside** it and becoming still is a solution.

The rule. Write the problem so another group could solve it from the paper. If they have to ask you what you meant, you have not set it yet.

GATE 3.3 • THE PROBLEM GATE

- ① Solve a problem the book set.
- ② Change one word of that problem and solve the new one.
- ③ Write your own problem with one constraint, and solve it.
- ④ Write your own problem with two constraints, and a partner can solve it from the writing alone.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and you can solve your partner's problem from their writing alone.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it.

► WATCH ME TRY

Sorrel tries again, on paper, before anybody moves. **First draft.** *Start behind the hoop and do a sequence.* Rowan: "How long? What counts as finished?" *Not yet a problem.* **Second draft.** *Start behind the hoop. Travel, turn, leave the ground, land inside the hoop, still.* Two constraints: start place, land inside. A finish a watcher can see. Tuft solves it from the paper, no talking. He lands inside and wobbles out. That is useful: the problem is hard enough to fail. Sorrel does not help him. Helping would turn it back into her problem.



The problem is on the paper, not in anybody's head. Bramble holds the sheet at chest height. Sorrel is already solving what is written, not what she wishes he had meant. The hoop is where the sentence put it.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

Rudolf Laban described movement through **body** (what the body does), **space** (where), **dynamics** or **effort** (how), and **relationships** (with whom or what).

When you write your own problem, those four words are the constraints you may pick from. "Travel low, slow, and never more than two steps from your partner" uses three of them, and a partner can start at once.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write a self-directed problem with **two** constraints. A partner who has not heard you talk must be able to start.

My problem:

Constraint 1:

Constraint 2:

- 2 Swap papers. Solve your partner's problem from the writing only. Then they solve yours.

- ☐ I could start without asking a question.
- ☐ I could fail the problem, which means it had a real constraint.

- ☐ My solution used a movement the paper did not already name.
- ☐ My partner could start mine without asking a question.
- 3** Ring the bar you held.
- ☐ Bar 1, given problem
- ☐ Bar 2, one word changed
- ☐ Bar 3, my own problem, one constraint
- ☐ Bar 4, two constraints, solved from the paper
- ☐ Bar 5, I also solved theirs from the paper

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Take a problem written by another three, from their paper only, and solve it in this orchard. Then write the one word you would add to make it clearer, and the one word you would take out because it did no work. Add: _____ Take out: _____

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Write a problem with **three** constraints that still has more than one possible answer. If your three constraints force a single phrase, you have written a sequence, not a problem.

UNIT 3 - TOPIC 3.4

Composition that says something

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Chalk or tape for a small performing patch under the trees, a drum or a tambourine if your teacher has one, four mood cards face down, a clipboard. Work in threes.

○ WARM UP

Cross the patch four times on a slow count of four: once as small as you can, once as wide, once sudden, once held. Do not name a mood yet. Feel how much the same walk changes when only the **how** changes.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

What must a self-directed task have, or it is only a wish?

Name Laban's four parts of movement.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan picks the word waiting. He stands under the third tree, still, and looks at Willow. "Standing," she says. "It is waiting," says Rowan. "Then I should be able to see waiting," says Willow, "and I can see standing."

► Learn

Objective 3.4 asks you to identify and demonstrate **compositional ideas** in order to express a selected **theme, mood or emotion**. This is not a dance exam. It is still Physical Education: a short phrase, built from the families you already have, judged on whether a watcher can **read** it.

IDEA	WHAT YOU DECIDE
Motif	a short phrase you repeat, so it becomes the thing the watcher remembers
Contrast	high then low, sudden then still, alone then together
Unison or canon	together on the same count, or one after the other
Pathway	straight, curved, or circling, like the corridinho's curve used on purpose

Laban's four parts are how you make those ideas do some work. **Body** is the movement. **Space** is where and how large. **Dynamics** is how: sudden, sustained, strong, light. **Relationship** is with whom, or with the hoop, or with the tree. A face you pull is not a composition. If you need the face, the movement has not said it yet.

The rule. Choose the mood before you move. Change body, space, dynamics or relationship until a watcher can name it from a list, with no title.

GATE 3.4 · THE READABLE GATE

- ① Choose a mood word and perform four movements you think show it.
- ② Change only the dynamics, and ask a watcher if the mood is clearer.
- ③ Change space as well: high or low, straight or curved.
- ④ A watcher names the mood from a list of four, and is right, without being told.
- ⑤ Two of you compose the same mood by relationship, and a third names it.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it.

► WATCH ME TRY

Rowan keeps four shapes: step, turn, look down the lane, still. **Go 1.** Ordinary walking speed, ordinary size. Willow writes *four movements. No mood.* **Go 2.** Same four shapes. He takes the step as if it might be a mistake, holds the turn, looks for a long count, and lets the still arrive late. Willow writes *waiting.* **Go 3.** Tuft joins him in canon, one count later. Willow writes *waiting*, and then *two people waiting on each other.* Go 2 is the repair. Rowan did not add a fifth movement and he did not act. **He changed how the four he already had were done.**



The same four shapes, two moods. On the left the phrase is small and held. On the right it is wide and sudden. Look at Willow: she is naming the mood from the movement, not from a card in anybody's hand.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

Rudolf Laban's four parts are also how a watcher reads you. They cannot see a mood. They can see what the body did, where it travelled, how the effort changed, and whom it was with. If those four are ordinary, the mood is invisible, however strongly you feel it.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Choose one mood from this list, and do not tell your watcher yet: *waiting, hurried, careful, glad*. Compose four movements. Tick every Laban part you actually changed on purpose.

Mood I chose: _____

- ☐ body (what)
- ☐ space (where, how large)
- ☐ dynamics (how)
- ☐ relationship (with whom or what)

My four movements, in order:

- 2 Perform it. The watcher names the mood from the same four words. If they were wrong, change **one** Laban part and go again.

They named _____ I changed _____

3 Ring the bar you held.

- ☐ Bar 1, four movements and a mood word
- ☐ Bar 2, dynamics changed
- ☐ Bar 3, space changed as well
- ☐ Bar 4, the watcher named it from the list
- ☐ Bar 5, two of us, one mood, a third named it

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Your watcher chooses the mood from the list and does not tell you until you are on the start of the patch. A mood you did not pick takes away the small habits you built for the one you like.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

The same four movements, then the **opposite** mood. Waiting becomes hurried. A watcher names both, in order. You pass when they can, and when you can point to the one Laban part that flipped the reading.

The orchard show

Six of you, one lane between the trees, thirty-five minutes, and this time the orchard is a small show. Not a concert. Three short pieces: a gymnastics phrase chosen from three answers, a rhythmic phrase that says a mood, and the same travel used once cooperatively and once competitively. You write the show down first. **The sheet is marked as well as the moving.**



The orchard show, just before it starts. Six of them in the lane between the trees, kit already placed, the chosen phrases written on one sheet. Nobody is still inventing. Look at the paper: that is where the marks are.

THE ORCHARD SHOW · THE FIVE STEPS

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
1	Invent more than you will use. Three answers for the gymnastics crossing. Two situations for the travel. Two moods for the rhythmic phrase.	Are the extras genuinely different, not the favourite one made faster?
2	Choose. One crossing, one pair of situations, one mood. Write why, on the sheet, before anybody performs.	Can a group that has never met you run the show from this sheet alone?
3	Make the choice readable. Rehearse only what you chose. Cut anything that is still in the pocket.	Can a watcher name the situation, the letter and the mood without a title?
4	Run the show. Three pieces, in the order on the sheet. Gymnastics first, then the two situations, then the mood.	Did you perform the choice, or did a spare answer sneak back in?
5	Be watched. A group who did not write your sheet names situation, letter and mood.	Three names, all correct, or the show has not said anything yet.

What good looks like: the unused answers are still on the sheet, not in the lane, and every one of the six can say which bar they were on in each piece.

Step 1 is the one people try to skip, because choosing feels like throwing work away. It is not. **The unused answers are how you know the remaining one was a choice.** Women's artistic gymnastics floor exercises have a maximum time of 90 seconds. Your three pieces together should sit comfortably inside that: if a piece needs longer, you have not chosen yet.

Our show, written down before we move

OUR ORCHARD SHEET

MINUTES	PIECE	WHAT WE CHOSE, AND WHY	WHO
_____	Gymnastics crossing	_____	_____
_____	Same travel, two situations	_____	_____
_____	Mood the watcher must name	_____	_____
_____	Being watched	_____	_____

Every row needs a choice and a name. A row with no name is a row where six of you stand still under the trees.

How did the orchard go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet. Answer for today, not for the go you wish you had had.

AT THE ORCHARD	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I named the situation before I invented for it	☐ ☐ ☐
A watcher could tell cooperative from competitive without a title	☐ ☐ ☐
I invented three answers from different families, not one answer three times	☐ ☐ ☐
I chose one answer out loud and performed only that one	☐ ☐ ☐

AT THE ORCHARD	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I wrote a problem another group could start from the paper	☐ ☐ ☐
My problem had a constraint somebody could actually fail	☐ ☐ ☐
A watcher named my mood from a list, without my face or a title	☐ ☐ ☐
I can say which Laban part I changed to make the mood readable	☐ ☐ ☐
Our orchard sheet could have been run by a group who had never met us	☐ ☐ ☐
The unused answers stayed on the paper and did not sneak back into the show	☐ ☐ ☐

The last two rows are worth as much as the eight about moving. In Year 6 the invention is cheap. The choice is the work, and the sheet is how somebody else knows you made one.

▪ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ name a situation before I invent for it: individual, cooperative, competitive, expressive
- ☐ remake one phrase so a watcher can tell cooperative from competitive
- ☐ invent three answers to one challenge from different skill families
- ☐ choose one answer out loud and perform only that one
- ☐ keep a chosen answer when a setter moves the hoop
- ☐ write a self-directed problem with two constraints a partner can fail
- ☐ solve a partner's problem from the paper, without asking what they meant
- ☐ compose four movements so a watcher can name a mood from a closed list
- ☐ say which of Laban's four parts I changed to make the mood readable
- ☐ use a motif, a contrast, unison or canon, or a pathway on purpose
- ☐ write an orchard sheet another group could run without me
- ☐ leave the unused answers on the paper, not in the lane

UNIT 4 • THE HAY MEADOW

4

Taking part

You already know how to join a game. This unit is about the four ways of being in one, what a named role actually commits you to, and how a group plans a match without anybody having to be in charge of it.



✓ ON THESE FIELDS YOU WILL

- ① take part alone, sharing space, in a pair, and in a small group, and name which
- ② say what a role commits you to, including what it forbids
- ③ write a short-term goal you can test this lesson or the next
- ④ lead by helping, and follow a lead without adding your own idea
- ⑤ use what you know about a body to refine a pattern, without ranking anybody
- ⑥ listen first, then plan together, then pin the sheet and stop arguing

△ BEFORE YOU GO UP

Name the last game you played on grass. Now say how much of it you spent with the ball, and how much of it you spent doing the job the game actually needed. Those are not the same number. A five-a-side basketball match has one ball and ten hands. If taking part meant touching it, six people would be wasting their time. The hay is short after the cut, so you can see the whole meadow at once.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.1

Four ways of taking part

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One ball that bounces, eight cones, bibs if you have them, a clipboard. Work in sixes, then split into 3 v 3.

○ WARM UP

Walk the meadow edge for one minute, changing direction when you meet somebody, without touching. Jog the same edge once. Then ten shoulder circles backwards.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.4, when another mover takes your space, what do you keep, and what do you change? Keep

Change

♦ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip practises his bounce-pass in the far corner for eight minutes. It is excellent. Then Rowan calls 3 v 3, and Pip stands next to whoever has the ball. "You were taking part," says Willow, "then you stopped. You are in the huddle. That is not one of the four ways."

► Learn

Year 3 asked you to join in. Year 6 asks you to **name which way you are in**.

WAY	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	WHAT IT IS NOT
Alone	the skill, nobody watching	hiding after your good bit
Sharing space	other bodies, no contact, a path left	bunching on the ball
A pair	one sending, one receiving	one working, one waiting
A small group	four to six, one job each	five people decorating one

Pip's bounce-pass was real individual work. The huddle was not a small group.

The rule for this topic. Name the way you are in. If you cannot name it, you are only near the ball.

GATE 4.1 • THE TAKING-PART GATE

- ① Ten bounce-passes **alone**.
- ② The same skill, two other bodies sharing the meadow, no contact.
- ③ The same skill as a **pair**: one sends, one receives, then swap.
- ④ Four of you, one ball. Everybody touches it before anybody may shoot.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and you can name which way you are in when a watcher stops you.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Your work is the bar above it. Say which one out loud before you go.

► WATCH ME TRY

Alone: ten bounce-passes, nine sit. **Sharing space:** Sorrel and Tuft run through and Pip never steps into their line. **3 v 3:** he hunts the ball and cannot name a way. **Then:** he takes a wide place, calls once, and when the ball does not come he leaves that space for Bramble. Small group. In, without touching it.



Four ways, one meadow. Left to right: Tuft alone with a ball, Pip and Sorrel sharing a lane, Bramble and Rowan as a pair, then four of them in a small group with one ball. Willow is on the fence post, and she is not counting touches.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

Basketball is **five a side**. The hoop is **3.05 metres** (10 feet) above the floor. On this meadow you will usually play **3 v 3**, with a lower target if there is no hoop out here. That is a modification. Five a side still means ten people and one ball, which is why all four ways have to live inside one match.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Tick every way you were actually in during the last three minutes.
☐ alone ☐ sharing space ☐ a pair ☐ a small group
- 2 Write the moment you were only near the ball, not in a way.
- 3 Play 3 v 3. After two minutes your watcher asks which way you are in. I said

It was ☐ true ☐ near the ball again

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap watcher. Stop them once and ask the question. If they name a way you cannot see, they were not in it.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Same 3 v 3, new rule: **the player who last touched the ball may not shoot**. You take part as a pair or a small group, or the team cannot finish.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.2

What a role actually commits you to

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One soft ball, eight cones for two small goals, bibs in two colours, a clipboard. Two groups of five, or one group of seven if you have them.

○ WARM UP

In a circle of six, pass one ball around, then add a second. If either ball stops, both restart. You are already responsible for the ball coming to you.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 4.1, name the four ways of taking part.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan hands out bibs. "You are attack, you are attack, you are defence." Everybody chases the ball. "A role is not a colour," says Willow. "A role is a list of things you will do, and a shorter list of things you will not."

► Learn

Year 2 gave you a bib. Year 4 gave you a job name. Year 6 asks what the name **commits you to**. If you are the goalkeeper, you stay in the area when the ball is at the other end. The test is whether the group can still see the role after two minutes.

ROLE	WHAT IT COMMITS YOU TO	WHAT IT FORBIDS
Goalkeeper	stop the shot, start the next attack	wandering out to join the chase
Passer	move the ball to a teammate who can use it	shooting the moment you feel like it
Shooter	take the chance the passer made	holding the ball to look busy
Marker	stay with one named body	leaving them to hunt the ball

The rule for this topic. A role you cannot fail at is not a role. Write the forbid column, or you are only wearing a bib.

GATE 4.2 · THE ROLE GATE

- ① Wear a bib and say the role name out loud.
- ② Name one thing the role **must** do.
- ③ Name one thing it **must not** do, and hold that for two minutes.
- ④ As bar 3, and a watcher can see the forbid without being told the name.
- ⑤ Swap mid-game on a signal and take the new commitment immediately.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 3 is the first one that is actually a role.

► WATCH ME TRY

Modified handball on the hay: a small goal, a crease of cones, no hitting. Tuft is goalkeeper. First minute he runs out to help and a shot goes in behind him. Second go he writes *I stay in the crease unless the ball is dead*. He stops a shot, the next attack starts without him, and he stays. The role held. A role that only shows when you have the ball is not a role. It is a turn.



Bibs with jobs written on them. Rowan is handing them out, but look at the other side of each bib: a short forbid, in pencil. Willow is not watching who scores. She is watching whether the goalkeeper is still in the crease.

▫ **DID YOU KNOW?**

Outdoor handball is **seven a side including the goalkeeper**. On this meadow you will often play fewer, because seven a side needs fourteen people and a bigger crease than the hay will give you. The outdoor game is still seven, and the goalkeeper is still one of those seven, not an extra.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Write your role as a commitment, not a name. I will

I will not

- 2 Play two minutes. Your watcher ticks what they could **see**.

☐ the must [] the must not [] neither: a bib and a chase

- 3 Swap on a signal. Write the new forbid before you move. New role

_____ I will not

→ **GO A LITTLE FURTHER**

Watch one teammate for two minutes and write only the forbid you saw them keep. If they say "that was not my role", it was never a commitment.

▲ **CLIMB A BAR**

Play the next two minutes with **no calling the role out**. The watcher names it from the forbid alone.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.3

Your own next goal, in writing

THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Four cones, one beanbag or baton per pair, a stopwatch, a clipboard. Work in threes: mover, timer, watcher.

WARM UP

Shuttle to a cone and back four times. After each go, write the number of clean changeovers you think you made. Then ask the watcher. The two numbers will not match.

DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 4.2, what is the difference between a role name and a role commitment?

WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft writes: Get better at catching. "When will you know?" says Willow. "When I am better," says Tuft. "That is a wish for next year," says Willow. "Write the next step."

Learn

A goal that cannot be tested is not a goal. It is a mood.

A short-term goal in this book is one you can test in the same lesson or the next one, not a wish for next year.

PART	WHAT YOU WRITE	WHAT DOES NOT COUNT
The next step	one action, small enough for today	"get better", "try harder"
The test	a number, or a detail a watcher can see	"when it feels right"

PART	WHAT YOU WRITE	WHAT DOES NOT COUNT
The window	this lesson, or the next one	"by the summer", "one day"

A Year 6 next step looks like this: *Four changeovers in a row without dropping the beanbag, tested before we leave the meadow.*

The rule for this topic. If a watcher cannot pass or fail it this morning, it is not short-term, and you have not written a goal.

GATE 4.3 · THE GOAL GATE

- ① Write a wish. (Most people start here. It does not count yet.)
- ② Rewrite it as a next step you can do today.
- ③ Add the test: a number, or one visible detail.
- ④ Test it in this lesson and write the result, pass or not yet.
- ⑤ Write tomorrow's next step from today's result, not from the old wish.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 1 is not a goal.

► WATCH ME TRY

Tuft's wish is bar 1. He rewrites: four changeovers, no drop, this lesson. Go 1, drop on the second changeover. He writes *not yet*, not "nearly". Go 2, four clean. He stops, then writes tomorrow from the result: *Four clean, and I start my run before I look back*. That last clause came from go 1, not from the wish.



The goal is on the paper, not in the air. Tuft has the pencil. Bramble has the watch. The beanbag is still on the hay because they have not started, which is the correct order. Three short lines, and nothing on them that says "get better".

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

A short-term goal in this book is one you can test in the same lesson or the next one, not a wish for next year. "Be a better teammate by June" is a kind sentence and a useless goal. "Pass first, every time I get the ball, for the next two minutes" is short-term. You can fail it before lunch.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write the wish you nearly wrote. Then cross it out.

- 2 Write the real goal. All three parts. Next step

The test

Window: [] this lesson [] next lesson

- 3 Test it. Write the result, then tomorrow's next step. Result

Tomorrow

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap books. Can your watcher pass or fail your goal without asking what you meant? If they have to ask, rewrite the test.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Take somebody else's result and write **their** next next-step from the evidence only. If they say "that is not what I meant", their test was pointing at the wrong thing.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.4

Leading, and being led well

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Six cones, one ball, a stopwatch, space for a group of six. No apparatus that needs an adult to set.

○ WARM UP

One of you leads two minutes: walk, jog, arm circles, ankle rises. The other five copy without adding a movement of their own. Then the lead moves on, and the group does not stop. The warm-up is already the work.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 4.3, a short-term goal in this book can be tested when?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip leads by standing in the middle and shouting "Faster!" The ankle rises disappear. Rowan leads the next two minutes from beside Tuft, who has lost the count. He counts with him until Tuft has it, then steps back into the line. The group is warmer after Rowan's two minutes.

► Learn

Leading, in this book, is **helping**, not being in charge. Being in charge looks like this: you talk most, you hold the ball at the restart, and the group waits for you. Helping looks like this: you notice the person who has lost the count, you give them the one thing they need, and you get out of the way. Following is the other half. Taking a lead means you do not add your own idea for the whole of that turn, even if your idea is better.

JOB	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU DO NOT DO
Lead	notice one problem, fix that one, hand it on	decide everything, keep the lead
Follow	do the thing that was asked, for the whole turn	start a second warm-up beside the first

The rule for this topic. If the group is waiting for you, you are in charge. If the group is moving, and one person is unstuck, you led.

GATE 4.4 · THE LEAD GATE

- ① Follow a lead for a whole warm-up without adding your own idea.
- ② Lead one named job for two minutes: cones, count, or the demonstration.
- ③ Lead by helping: leave your own go to fix one problem, then return.
- ④ Hand the lead on, and the group does not stop.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and the person who was stuck can name what you did that helped.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 is marked by the person you helped, not by you.

► WATCH ME TRY

Rowan stands in the middle and the drill starts late: in charge. Then he notices Bramble waiting without a partner, becomes the partner for four passes, and leaves: helping. Then he hands the lead to Tuft and follows a quiet first instruction: being led well, on purpose, by the person who finds leading hardest.



Rowan organising, and not from the middle. He is on the left, one arm out, setting the next cone. The other five are already moving. Look at Tuft, who had lost the count: Rowan is close enough to help and not so close that he has taken the turn back.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

A lead that needs you to stay in the middle will collapse when you sit down. The meadow match has to run when the person who planned it is busy playing. If you can point to the person who is "in charge", the lead has not been handed on yet.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Follow for two minutes. Write the one idea you did **not** add.
- 2 Lead by helping. Write the problem you fixed, and what you did next. The problem
Then I
- 3 Ask the person you helped to finish this. What helped was

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Hand the lead to the person who has not had it. Follow them for a full two minutes, including the awkward first twenty seconds.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Lead a restart after a stop. The group must be moving again in ten seconds, and you must not be the person with the ball.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.5

Using what you know about a body

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Unihoc-style sticks if your school has them, one light ball, eight cones, bibs. If you have no sticks, use open-palm hockey with a soft ball: the hand is the stick, and it stays below the waist. Work in fours.

+ STAY SAFE

Sticks stay below the knee. The ball stays on the ground. No slashing, no lifting, no hitting another stick or another body. An adult sets the space and checks the sticks. If a stick comes up, the game stops. Same height rule for open-palm hockey.

○ WARM UP

In pairs, walk the meadow mirroring each other. Then swap who leads the mirror. You are already collecting information about a body. Keep it.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 4.4, what is the difference between leading and being in charge?

Leading is _____ . Being in charge is

_____ .

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

They put Sorrel, who is the fastest, as the static shooter, and Bramble, who is strong and does not rush, as the runner who fetches every wide ball. The pattern falls apart in under a minute. "You used the names," says Willow, "and ignored the bodies."

► **Learn**

A **strength** is a thing this body already does well. An **area for improvement** is a thing it cannot hold yet. **Potential** is the next thing it is ready to try, not the thing it is worst at. Year 6 asks you to **use** what you know so the pattern fits the bodies that are actually here. There is no best body on this meadow.

WHAT YOU KNOW	HOW YOU USE IT
this body is fast over short grass	give it the first run, not the still job
this body reads space before it moves	put it where collisions start
this body is still learning the stick	give it a shorter lane, not a smaller job

The rule for this topic. Change the pattern to fit the body. Do not rank the bodies to fit the pattern you already liked.

GATE 4.5 · THE BODY GATE

- ① Name one strength of your own body in this game.
- ② Name one area to improve, and one thing it is ready to do next.
- ③ Name one strength of a partner's body, without comparing it to yours.
- ④ Change **one** detail of the pattern because of what you know about that body.
- ⑤ The partner can say the change helped, and name how.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 3 fails if the sentence has the word better in it.

► **WATCH ME TRY**

Sorrel runs the first length. Bramble takes the still shot. Tuft stands where the lanes cross. The ball goes through. They swap Sorrel and Bramble back "to be fair" and the ball dies: a rota, not fairness. They restore the first pattern and shorten Tuft's lane. Same job, smaller space.



The same pattern, redrawn around the bodies. Sorrel is already moving. Bramble is still, stick down, waiting for the ball. Tuft is in the short crossing lane. Nobody is being compared with anybody else. The pattern changed. The bodies did not have to.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

Potential is not a compliment and it is not a ranking. It is a next step, small enough to test this lesson or the next. "You could be brilliant" is not potential. "This body is ready for the crossing job in a shorter lane" is.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Fill this in for your own body, in this game. Strength

To improve

Ready next

- 2 Write one strength of your partner's body. If the word *better* appears, cross it out and start again.

- 3 Change one detail of the pattern. We changed

They said

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Play the refined pattern for two minutes, then the old one for two. Your watcher writes which one lost the ball less often. That is information about the pattern, not about who is better.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Write a next step for your partner's body, in their book, from what you saw. Keep the sentence only if the owner agrees it is testable this lesson or the next.

UNIT 4 - TOPIC 4.6**Planning together without arguing****■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

A clipboard, a pencil, the day sheet in this book, cones, one ball, bibs. Six of you. Sit first. Do not fetch the rest until the sheet is filled.

○ WARM UP

In threes: one person describes a route across the meadow in four sentences. The other two walk it without asking a question until the end, then say back one sentence. If that sentence is wrong, the speaker was not clear.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 4.5, what is potential, in this book?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

They stand in the hay and argue about which game to play. Eight minutes go. Nobody has moved. Willow pins a blank day sheet to the fence post. "One sentence each," she says. "Then we write. Then we play. The arguing is finished."

► Learn

Patience is **not using your sentence until you have heard theirs**. Care is writing their idea down so it is still there when you add yours. A group that plans with its mouths finishes the argument and not the game.

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU DO NOT DO
1	each person says one sentence	start yours before theirs is finished
2	repeat the plan back in one line	"yes but" before that line is spoken
3	add one change, then stop talking	add a second change because it is better
4	fill every box, then pin the sheet	keep a private plan in your head
5	run it. Change the sheet once if it fails	reopen the argument on the grass

The rule for this topic. Once the sheet is pinned, the talking about the plan is over. You may change the sheet. You may not stand in the hay and start again.

GATE 4.6 • THE PLAN GATE

- ① Listen to one whole plan without interrupting.
- ② Repeat it back in one sentence.
- ③ Add one change, then stop talking.
- ④ Write the plan together so every box is filled, then pin it.
- ⑤ Run it. Nobody argues once the sheet is on the post.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 is marked by the group.

► WATCH ME TRY

One sentence each. Pip: basketball first. Tuft: a relay so everybody starts together. Bramble: four minutes each, or we will not rotate. Rowan: I will take the least popular job. Willow: pin the sheet before the cones move. One line back, one change (a two-minute handball in the middle), then every box filled and pinned. Eight minutes of arguing became four minutes of writing and a morning that actually started.



The argument is over because the pencil is moving. All six are round the fence post, and Rowan is writing, not talking. Look at Pip: his mouth is closed. The cones are still in a stack. That is the correct order on this meadow.

▫ DID YOU KNOW?

A pinned sheet is not a decoration. It is the thing that lets a quieter person's sentence survive the walk from the post to the cones. If the plan lives only in the loudest head, the group did not plan together. They were briefed. Year 6 does not count a briefing as bar 4.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Write the one sentence you will say, before you say it. Then say only that.
- 2 After everybody has spoken, write the one-line plan you all repeated back.
- 3 Tick what is true before anybody fetches a cone.
 - ☐ every box has something in it
 - ☐ a name is on every row
 - ☐ I can point to somebody else's idea on the sheet
 - ☐ the sheet is pinned, and I have stopped arguing

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Run the first four minutes exactly as pinned. If it fails, change **one** box, pin it again, and run the next four. Do not hold a meeting.

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Swap sheets with another six. Run **their** first four minutes from the paper only. Then tell them the one box a stranger could not follow.

The meadow match

Six of you, the hay meadow, thirty-five minutes, and this time the match is one you wrote down. **You write it first, and the sheet is marked as well as the moving.** The score is not the mark. The mark is whether another six could run this morning from your paper alone.



The meadow match, after the sheet was pinned. Three small games are live on the short hay at once: a 3 v 3, a crease with a keeper, and a unihoc lane. Nobody is standing in a huddle waiting to be told. The paper is still on the fence post, which is where the marks are.

THE MEADOW MATCH · THE FIVE STEPS

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
1	Listen, then write. One sentence each. One line back. One change. Pin the sheet before the cones move.	Can a stranger find a name, a place and a job on every row?
2	Name the roles. Each person writes a must and a must not. Bibs go on after the writing.	Can a watcher see the forbid without being told the name?
3	Write the next step. One short-term goal each, testable this morning.	Can the watcher pass or fail it before you leave the meadow?
4	Play the stations. Modified basketball, handball, unihoc-style, then a relay. Four minutes each. Lead rotates by helping.	Did everybody take part in more than one way, and did the lead move on?
5	Change the sheet once if a station fails. Pin it again. Do not reopen the argument.	Is the talking about the plan actually over?

What good looks like: the sheet is still on the post, with one change in pencil, and every one of the six can say which way they were in, which role they held, and whether their goal passed.

Our match, written down before we move

OUR MEADOW SHEET

MINUTES	STATION	WHAT HAPPENS THERE	WHO LEADS BY HELPING

Every row needs all four boxes. A row with no lead on it is a row where six of you wait for Rowan.

My role: I will

I will not

My short-term goal, with its test:

Result, before we leave: [] passed [] not yet

♦ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Four stations, every box filled. Five forbids visible. One bib still only a colour. Four goals testable this morning. Lead moved on three times.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

a meadow sheet passes when every station names a place, a job and a helper, and the talking stops when the pencil does.

How did the meadow go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet. Answer for today, not for your best ever go.

ON THE HAY MEADOW	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I took part alone, sharing space, in a pair, and in a small group	☐ ☐ ☐
I could name which of the four ways I was in when a watcher asked	☐ ☐ ☐
I wrote a must and a must not, and a watcher could see the forbid	☐ ☐ ☐
My short-term goal had a test I could use this lesson or the next	☐ ☐ ☐
I led by helping, handed the lead on, and followed without adding an idea	☐ ☐ ☐
I used what I know about a body to change one detail, without ranking	☐ ☐ ☐
I listened first, then wrote, then stopped arguing once the sheet was pinned	☐ ☐ ☐
Our meadow sheet could have been run by a group who had never met us	☐ ☐ ☐

▪ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ take part alone, sharing space, in a pair, and in a small group
- ☐ name which of the four ways I am in, out loud, when asked
- ☐ write what a role commits me to, including what it forbids
- ☐ write a short-term goal I can test this lesson or the next
- ☐ lead by helping, then hand the lead on

- ☐ follow a lead without adding my own idea
- ☐ change one detail of a pattern to fit a body, without ranking anybody
- ☐ pin a day sheet and stop arguing once it is on the post

UNIT 5 • THE TACK ROOM

5

Taking responsibility

You already know how to move. This unit is the jobs that let other people move: sharing heavy kit, making a deal instead of a win, keeping a game fair, asking for help at the right moment, and saying something afterwards that somebody can use.



✓ ON THESE FIELDS YOU WILL

- ① share space and heavy kit skilfully and safely, talking as you carry
- ② negotiate over kit, space and ideas: a deal, not a win
- ③ follow fair-play rules, and officiate a short game with arm signals
- ④ ask for help at the right moment, using more than one way
- ⑤ give feedback that names one thing seen and one next try

△ BEFORE YOU GO UP

Name the last piece of kit you used. Now name who put it away.

If you cannot, that is this unit. The tack room is a stone shed on the high fields, with hooks, shelves and the heavy kit the whole year shares. Nobody owns a mat. The work is getting kit out, using the space without crowding it, and leaving both ready for the next group. Leadership here means helping.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.1

Heavy kit, shared safely

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Two gym mats, one ball bag two people can lift, six cones, chalk for a path. An adult sets out any bench. Pairs for carrying, then fours.

○ WARM UP

Walk one mat the long way and back. The person at the front says "go" and "down". Nobody runs. Swap ends.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From Getting set up, what does rule 8 ask you to do at the end?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip takes two mats at once because he is quick. The first slides. He cannot see Tuft coming the other way with the ball bag. The doorway is blocked. "I was helping," says Pip. "You were hurrying," says Willow.

► **Learn**

Heavy kit is anything you cannot carry at chest height with your elbows in, on your own, and still see the path. A mat is heavy kit. A full ball bag is heavy kit. A bench is heavy kit, and an adult moves that one.

THE JOB	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE
Two-person carry	Both hold, both look. Front says "go" and "down".
A clear path	Route said first. Nobody throws a mat. Nobody runs with one.
Put away is the last skill	Stacked, straps in, doorway clear.

The rule for this topic. Two people, two words, a path said first, and put away counts.

GATE 5.1 • THE CARRY GATE

- ① Two of you carry one mat across the clay. Talk. Put it down together.
- ② Carry it back by a different route, still talking, still walking.
- ③ Two pieces of kit, two trips, never overloaded.
- ④ As bar 3, and you put both away so the next pair can find them without asking.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and you talk a third pair through the same carry without doing it for them.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 is leadership, and leadership here means helping.

+ STAY SAFE

- ① Two people for anything you cannot carry at chest height with your elbows in. If you are not sure, it is two people.
- ② Walk. Never run. Never throw a mat, a bag or a bench.

- 3 The person at the front looks where they are going and says "go" and "down". The person at the back does not push.
- 4 Stack so it cannot slide. Leave the doorway clear. Tell an adult if a lift feels unsafe.

► WATCH ME TRY

Pip goes again with Tuft. One mat. Pip at the front. **Attempt 1.** He says "go" before Tuft has both hands on. The mat twists. **Attempt 2.** They name the route first. Pip waits for "ready". They walk it, then stack both mats, doorway clear. *The job finishes when the next pair can start.*



Out, used, and put away. A two-person carry at chest height, ball bag already on the shelf, doorway empty.

• **YOUR TURN**

- 1 I am working on bar _____ Front: _____ Back: _____
 _____ Route: _____

- 2 Three carries. Tick what was true.

GO	HANDS ON BEFORE "GO"	WALKED	DOWN TOGETHER	PATH CL
1	_____	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____	_____

- 3 Draw the tack room after put-away: mats stacked, bag on its shelf, doorway as a ring.

THE TACK ROOM, AFTER WE PUT THE KIT AWAY

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.2

Negotiating, not winning

■ **THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

One hoop, four cones, one ball, chalk, a clipboard. Six people and not enough of one thing. The shortage is the lesson.

○ WARM UP

Two of you, one cone. Twenty seconds to decide who starts, without grabbing. Then start. If somebody grabbed, do it again.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

One hoop. Sorrel wants it for a turning sequence. Bramble wants it for a target. Both of them are already holding the rim. "I had it first," says Sorrel. "I need it more," says Bramble. Willow writes: two minutes gone, hoop still not in use, four people waiting.

► Learn

Negotiating is how two ideas share one object, one patch of clay, or one turn. If you "won" and the other person is standing still, you did not negotiate. You took the kit.

STEP	WHAT YOU DO
1. Need	Each person says what they need, in one sentence.
2. Limit	You name the shared limit out loud: one hoop, two minutes, six people.
3. Deal	You write a deal both can work with: rotate, combine, or pick a third option.

The rule for this topic. Say the need, name the limit, write the deal. Then run it without reopening it.

GATE 5.2 • THE DEAL GATE

- ① Each person says what they need in one sentence.
- ② You name the shared limit out loud.
- ③ You write a deal both of you can work with.
- ④ You run that deal for three minutes without reopening it.
- ⑤ A third person joins. You remake the deal so all three can work.

Ring the bar you can hold today. A deal that only works for two of you is not finished.

► WATCH ME TRY

Need. Sorrel: *three turns through the hoop*. Bramble: *three throws at it*. **Limit.** One hoop. Three minutes. **Attempt 1.** Sorrel uses it first for all three turns. Bramble waits. *A queue, not a deal*. **Attempt 2.** Two minutes of turns, then two minutes of throws, hoop left in the same chalk ring. Rowan times. *Both ideas ran. The hoop moved once.*



Two ideas, one hoop, and a pencil. Sorrel points at the chalk ring. The hoop is still on the ground. Nobody is pulling.

• **YOUR TURN**

1 We are short of

Need A:

Need B:

Limit:

Our deal:

2 Run it for three minutes.

- ☐ Both needs got time, not only the louder one.
- ☐ We did not reopen the deal halfway through.
- ☐ Nobody stood still for the whole three minutes.

3 Add a third person. The new deal:

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Swap your written deal with another pair and run **theirs** for two minutes, from the paper only. Tell them the one line that was not clear enough to use.

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.3

Fair play when the score matters

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Four cones, one soft ball, two markers for goals or targets, clipboard, chalk. Six people: two v two, one official, one watcher. An adult watches the game.

○ WARM UP

When the official raises one arm straight up, freeze, even if you were about to throw. Count of three. Then put the ball down. Do it four times.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From Getting set up, what does rule 9 ask when you hear "stop"?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan is the official. He raises one arm. Pip has just thrown. The ball goes in. Pip shouts the score. "Stop came first," says Rowan. "No goal. Restart from the cone." Pip takes a step towards him. "That is not fair. It was already in the air." The game is now two people arguing and four people waiting.

► **Learn**

A game needs rules because two sides both want to score. Year 6 adds a job. Somebody **officiates**: start, stop, score, restart, a basic foul, and a word that keeps the game fair. That is helping the game to continue.

JOB	ARM SIGNAL	WHAT YOU SAY
Start	both arms up, then drop	"Play."
Stop	one arm straight up	"Stop."
Score	point to the side that scored	both numbers, the new score
Restart	ball at the spot, wait, then drop the arm	"Restart."
Foul	one arm across the chest, then point	the foul in three words, then the restart
Fair play	nothing extra	a short line that helps them restart

A basic foul here is contact, playing on after stop, or running with the kit.

The rule for this topic. Accept the official's decision without argument, and restart the game.

GATE 5.3 • THE FAIR-PLAY GATE

- ① Play one minute with an official. Restart when they say.
- ② Accept one decision you did not like, without a word, and restart.
- ③ You officiate: start, stop, one score, one restart.
- ④ You officiate a foul: name it in three words, restart, and the players go.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and you encourage fair play once without stopping the game for a speech.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 2 is the one most people skip, and it is the whole topic.

+ STAY SAFE

Throwing. Throw only when the space in front of you is empty. Face the target. Collect on a signal, never while somebody else is throwing. **Stopping on instruction.** When the official's arm goes up, or when you hear "stop", you stop. Not after this throw. Now. If the ball is already in the air, let it land, then put it down. You do not argue. You restart when the official starts you.

► WATCH ME TRY

Go 1. Rowan calls stop. Pip's throw is already in the air and goes in. Pip opens his mouth, shuts it, walks to the cone. *The restart took four seconds.* **Go 2.** Pip officiates. He waits until both sides look, then drops his arms. He sees contact, arm across the chest, points, says "contact, restart here." They go. *The game continued. That is the official's job.*



The restart, not the argument. Both on their marks, ball on the chalk spot, nobody pointing.



The official is helping the game, not performing. Rowan is side-on with one arm straight up. Nobody has a whistle in their mouth. The four players have frozen.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

Fair play includes accepting the official's decision without argument and restarting the game. The restart is the proof. A polite face with no restart is still a stopped lesson.

● YOUR TURN

1 Write the six people into the jobs. Swap after each minute.

MINUTE	SIDE A	SIDE B	OFFICIAL	WATCHER
1	_____	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____	_____

2 When you officiate, tick every signal you actually used.

- ☐ start
- ☐ stop
- ☐ score
- ☐ restart
- ☐ foul
- ☐ a fair-play line that helped them restart

3 The decision I did not like:

What I did next:

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.4

Asking for help at the right moment

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Four cones, one ball, one hoop, a mat set out by an adult, a clipboard. Threes: mover, helper, watcher.

○ WARM UP

Ten throws at a target. After two misses, the mover may ask the helper **one** question. After that, no talking until throw ten.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft's landing keeps putting his second foot down. He says nothing and does it eight more times. Pip shouts "your foot!" in the middle of Sorrel's throw. The throw goes into the wall. Tuft asked too late. Pip asked at the wrong moment.

► **Learn**

Year 6 asks you to have **more than one way** of getting help, and to pick the moment.

WAY	WHAT YOU DO	WHEN
Try once more	Name the stuck bit. One more go on your own.	Straight after a miss.
Ask a teammate	One specific question: a body part or a decision.	Between goes.
Swap jobs	Watch the thing you cannot feel.	At a stop.
Tell an adult	Hurt, or kit that feels unsafe.	At once.

Wrong moments: while kit is being carried, while a throw is in the air, while the official is giving a decision, and after you have already hurt yourself and kept going.

The rule for this topic. Choose a way. Choose a moment. Do not play on if you are hurt.

GATE 5.4 · THE HELP GATE

- ① Name the stuck bit. Try one more time on your own.
- ② Ask a teammate one specific question, between goes.
- ③ Swap jobs so you can watch the thing you cannot feel.
- ④ Ask at the next stop, not while kit is moving or a throw is in the air.
- ⑤ If you are hurt, or the kit is unsafe: stop, tell an adult, do not play on.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 is not a harder trick. Take it the moment you need it.

+ STAY SAFE

If you are hurt, the sequence in this book is: **stop, tell an adult, do not play on.** You do not test the hurt to see whether it does it twice. You do not wait until the score is finished. Stop. Tell an adult. Do not play on.

► WATCH ME TRY

Tuft names the stuck bit: *second foot down on the landing*. One more go. Still down. **Wrong moment.** He starts the question while Pip is throwing. The throw dies. **Right moment.** He waits until the official's arm has dropped and the ball is dead. "Watch my landing foot." *The help arrived when nobody else was in the middle of a skill.*



The question waits. Tuft is still, one hand slightly raised, looking at Willow. The ball is on the ground. Pip has finished his throw. That gap is the right moment.

● YOUR TURN

1 The stuck bit is

2 Tick the way you used.

☐ tried once more on my own

☐ asked a teammate one specific question

- ☐ swapped jobs so I could watch
- ☐ told an adult (hurt, or unsafe kit) The moment:

The exact question:

- 3 Watcher ticks the timing.
 - ☐ between goes, or at a stop
 - ☐ too early (a throw or a carry was still happening)
 - ☐ too late (I had already kept going on a hurt)
-

UNIT 5 - TOPIC 5.5

Feedback somebody can use

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

The same small game as 5.3, plus a clipboard for every watcher. Threes: mover, official or carrier, watcher.

○ WARM UP

Watch one throw. Write one body part you saw move. If the line still works with "good" or "bad" stuck in, it is not ready.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip watches Bramble's throw. "Good," he says. Bramble throws again, the same way. "Bad," says Pip. Bramble now knows Pip's mood. He does not know what to change.

► Learn

"Good" and "bad" are not feedback. They are a score with the numbers left off.

PART	WHAT IT NAMES	EXAMPLE
What I saw	one body part, or one decision	"Your front foot pointed at the wall."
The next try	one thing to do on the following go	"Point it at the target, then throw."

Wait until they have finished. Ask if they want the comment. Say it once. Receiving is not explaining why the first go was unlucky. It is using the next try.

The rule for this topic. One thing seen, one next try. Not "good". Not "bad".

GATE 5.5 · THE FEEDBACK GATE

- ① Watch one go. Write one body part or one decision you saw.
- ② Add one next try. Read both lines out.
- ③ The mover uses the next try on the following go.
- ④ Swap. Receive the comment without explaining yourself.
- ⑤ Give the same kind of comment to an official, a carrier or a negotiator.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 treats helping as a real job.

► WATCH ME TRY

Pip's version: *Good. Bad.* Bramble's third throw matches his first. **Willow's version:** *Your elbow dropped below your shoulder on the throw. Next try: keep the elbow at shoulder height until the ball has gone.* Bramble's next throw: elbow stays. The ball still misses. That is allowed. The feedback was used. Missing is a different problem, for a different go.



A comment you can take onto the next go. Willow is low, clipboard on her knee, looking at Bramble's throwing arm and nothing else. Bramble is listening. He has not started explaining.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

A constructive comment names one body part or one decision and one next try. "Good" and "bad" are not feedback. They tell you a mood. They do not tell you what to do.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Watch three goes. Do not write good or bad.

GO	ONE BODY PART OR ONE DECISION	ONE NEXT TRY
1		
2		
3		

- 2 Cross out any line that still makes sense with "good" or "bad" swapped in. The line I rewrote:
-
- 3 I was given:
-
- I used it on the next go: _____ Bar 5. Job I watched:
- _____ What I saw:
-
- Next try:
-

The tack-room morning

Six of you, the tack room, thirty minutes. Carry the kit, write a deal, play with an official, ask for help once, and leave one comment somebody can use. **Write the morning down first. The plan is marked as well as the play.**

Kit going out of the tack room, two at a time. Look at the doorway: it is clear behind them, and the bag is already on the shelf. That is the put-away row written before anybody played.

THE TACK-ROOM MORNING · THE FIVE STEPS

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
1	Plan it. Minutes, kit, the deal, who officiates. Before anybody lifts anything.	Could a group that has never met you run this from the sheet alone?

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
2	Share the kit. Two-person carries. Path said first. Put away is part of the step.	Two people, two words, doorway clear?
3	Play the deal. A short game you negotiated. One official, arm signals, restarts.	Did the official's decisions stand, and did the game restart?
4	Ask once. Each person uses one help-seeking way at a chosen moment.	Specific question, at a stop or between goes?
5	Leave a comment. One body part or one decision, and one next try.	Would it still work with good and bad taken out? It should: they were never in it.

The next group can use the tack room without asking you a single question, and every one of the six can say which bar they were on.

Step 1 is the one that gets skipped, and skipping it is how six people end up in the doorway with two mats and no official.

Our morning, written down before we lift anything

OUR TACK-ROOM SHEET

MINUTES	KIT / SPACE	WHAT HAPPENS THERE	WHO
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

Write the deal in the third column. Write the official's name, not "we will see".

Our deal, in one sentence:

The official for minute one: _____

♦ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Sheet: four rows filled, but put-away never had a row.

Carry two-person; Rowan officiated one foul and a restart; Tuft asked at the stop; the comment named an elbow and a next try.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

a tack-room sheet passes when the kit has a put-away row, the deal is written, the official is named, and a group who had never met you could start from it.

How did the tack room go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet. Answer for today, not for your best ever go.

AT THE TACK ROOM	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I carried heavy kit with a partner, talking, and we put it away	☐ ☐ ☐
I negotiated a deal instead of winning the kit	☐ ☐ ☐
I accepted an official's decision without argument and restarted	☐ ☐ ☐
I officiated a short game: start, stop, score, restart	☐ ☐ ☐
I asked for help at the right moment, with a specific question	☐ ☐ ☐
If I had been hurt I would have stopped, told an adult, and not played on	☐ ☐ ☐
I gave a comment with one thing seen and one next try	☐ ☐ ☐
I received a comment without explaining myself	☐ ☐ ☐
Our day sheet could have been run by a group who had never met us	☐ ☐ ☐
As a helper, I made the next person's job easier, not louder	☐ ☐ ☐

▪ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ carry heavy kit with a partner, using "go" and "down", and put it away

- ☐ share a space without blocking the path for the next pair
- ☐ say a need, name a limit, and write a deal both people can use
- ☐ run a deal for three minutes without reopening it
- ☐ accept an official's decision without argument and restart
- ☐ officiate a short game: start, stop, score, restart, one basic foul
- ☐ encourage fair play without stopping the game for a speech
- ☐ ask for help with one specific question at a stop or between goes
- ☐ stop, tell an adult, and not play on if I am hurt
- ☐ give feedback that names one body part or one decision and one next try
- ☐ receive feedback and use the next try
- ☐ write a tack-room sheet another group could run without me

UNIT 6 · THE HILL SPRING

6

Healthy bodies

Five units have asked this body to work. This one asks whether you can keep it working, on purpose, when nobody is standing over you with a clipboard. The spring is the last place on the high fields.



✓ ON THESE FIELDS YOU WILL

- ① say why activity matters for health, fitness and wellbeing, and sketch a week that actually does it
- ② name the parts, joints and muscles a movement uses, and the component of fitness it trains
- ③ plan a range of activities, then evaluate and compare how hard each one felt
- ④ assess a risk before you take it, and change one thing so the work can still run
- ⑤ build a warm-up and a cool-down from their real parts, and say why each part is there
- ⑥ choose water and a simple mixed meal for a moving day, without turning lunch into a test

△ BEFORE YOU GO UP

Walk up to the spring. Sit on the dry stone, not the wet one. You have a repertoire, you can link unlike movements, and you can hold a bar when the ground changes. None of that is any use if the body that does it arrives cold, empty, thirsty, or so tired that talking is already hard. This unit is not a new skill family. It is the last job of primary PE: looking after the engine, on paper first, then on the loop around the water.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.1

Why any of this matters

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Clipboard, pencil, space to walk then jog the spring loop once. Work in threes. Bottles stay on the dry stone, not on the path.

○ WARM UP

Walk the loop once, changing direction when you meet somebody, without touching. Then ten shoulder circles backwards, ten ankle rises, five slow squats to halfway. Stand still. If you cannot yet talk easily, that was not a warm-up.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From Getting set up, what does the book ask you to do before anybody moves?

From Unit 1: a skill you stop spending time on goes rusty. What happens to a body you stop looking after?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip is asked why PE matters. "So we win Athletics Day," he says. Willow asks what he did yesterday after school, and Sunday. Pip cannot remember anything that counts. That is the answer, and it is also why he is tired on a Monday.

► Learn

Physical activity does three different jobs, and they are not the same word.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS HERE
Health	the body can do a school day; you recover after a hard go; sleep is in the week
Fitness	named components actually work: stamina, speed, the rest of the list in 6.2
Wellbeing	you feel more like yourself after moving than you did before it

Winning a race is a fine thing and it is not the reason this unit exists. A body that only works when a teacher is watching is not a healthy one. It is a borrowed one. Children aged 6 to 12 generally need **9 to 12 hours of sleep in 24 hours**. A late night is why Tuesday's loop feels harder than Monday's, on the same clay. Rest is a day in the week, not four empty ones with a new name.

The rule for this topic is short. Activity matters because the week is made of it, not the lesson. Rest and sleep are part of the same week.

GATE 6.1 • THE WEEK GATE

- ① Name three changes you felt after today's moving.
- ② Name one activity **outside** this lesson that counts.
- ③ Sketch a week that could average sixty moving minutes a day, and mark a rest.
- ④ As bar 3, and you label which minutes are moderate and which are vigorous.
- ⑤ As bar 4, and you can say which day is the thin one, and what you would add without taking the rest out.

Ring the bar you can hold today. A week with no rest is not a harder week. It is a shorter one.

► WATCH ME TRY

Pip writes his week honestly. Monday and Wednesday: this lesson, all sprinting. Tuesday and the weekend: he cannot remember. Two vigorous bursts and four quiet days is not an average. It is a gap with a PE lesson in it. Bramble's week is quieter and longer: walking the hill, a Saturday kickabout, this lesson at a pace he can talk at, Sunday with no stations. He is not fitter than Pip because he is better. He is fitter this month because the minutes are spread out, and because he slept. They did not compare bodies. They compared **weeks**.



Not a race up the last hill. The six of them have reached the spring and they are still on their feet. Bramble has the watch down by his side. Pip is talking, which is the point: a moving day you can still speak in the middle of.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

The UK Chief Medical Officers say that children and young people aged 5 to 18 should average at least **60 minutes of moderate-to-vigorous physical activity per day across the week**. It is an average, not a punishment timer on every afternoon. A quiet Tuesday and a long Saturday can share the same week. A week with nothing in it except two PE lessons cannot.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 After the loop, tick what you felt: ☐ breathing faster ☐ warmer ☐ I could still talk in a sentence ☐ I wanted water
- 2 Sketch **your** week. Write what moved, or write "nothing" rather than inventing.
 Mon _____ Tue _____ Wed _____
 Thu _____ Fri _____ Sat _____ Sun _____

3 The thin day is _____. I would add

Bar on the week gate: [] 1 [] 2 [] 3 [] 4 [] 5

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap sheets. Do not improve their week for them. Ask which day would fall over first if the week got busy, and what stays if that day goes.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.2

Naming the parts, and the components

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Space to jump, throw, balance, change direction and do one short sprint. A partner to watch which parts actually move.

○ WARM UP

Name each joint as you go: circle the ankles, bend and straighten the knees, open the hips, swing the arms from the shoulders, bend and straighten the elbows. Ten of each. The naming is the warm-up.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 6.1, activity does three jobs. Name them. _____

_____ Which of the three is not the same as being the fastest? _____

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel finishes a sprint and slaps the front of her thigh. "Fitness," she says. "Speed. That is the component." Willow writes what she saw: ankle, knee, hip, shoulder, elbow, both sides of the thigh, the calves, and the middle holding it up. "You used eight parts to train one component," she says, "and Saturday's game will last longer than this sprint."

► Learn

A movement has **parts, joints** and **muscles**. Fitness has **components**. Year 6 names both, because "my legs" is not a diagnosis and "being fit" is not a plan.

Joints on these fields: ankle, knee, hip, spine, shoulder, elbow, wrist. Muscles you should be able to point to: **quadriceps** (front of the thigh), **hamstrings** (back of the thigh), **calves**, **abdominals** (the middle), **shoulders**, **biceps** (front of the upper arm). The engine you cannot see is the **heart** and the **lungs**, which do the long work. You point, you name, you say what it is doing.

COMPONENT	WHAT IT IS, ON THE SPRING LOOP
Stamina	keeping going, at a pace you can still talk at
Agility	changing direction without falling over the plan
Speed	a short fast go, then you stop
Coordination	hands, feet and eyes agreeing
Balance	holding still, or holding a shape while you move
Bodyweight strength	pushing, holding or pulling your own body
Flexibility	a joint moving through a useful range, without bouncing it
Reaction	starting, stopping or catching when something happens suddenly

Sorrel's sprint trains **speed**. It uses almost every joint in the list. It does almost nothing for stamina. That is why a week needs more than one component.

The rule for this topic. Name the part that is working, then name the job it is doing. Fitness is a list, not a feeling that you are fast.

GATE 6.2 • THE NAMING GATE

- ① Point to two body parts a named movement uses.
- ② Add the joints, and one muscle, with what each is doing.
- ③ Name the **component** that movement trains, and one it barely touches.
- ④ Match four stations to four different components, out loud, before you start.
- ⑤ Watch somebody else and name part, joint, muscle and component without being told the station.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 is the watcher bar.

► WATCH ME TRY

Sorrel does a two-footed jump and land. **Take-off:** ankles, knees and hips extend; quadriceps and calves push. *Bodyweight strength.* **Landing:** knees and hips flex; quadriceps and hamstrings share the down; ankles stay springy, not locked. What the jump is not: stamina. One jump does not keep you going. If she wants stamina she needs the loop, not a higher jump.



The landing is a list. Sorrel is on the way down, not the way up. Look at the knees: they are already bending. Look at the middle: it is holding. Willow is close in, watching the knees and nothing else.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Do **one** movement. [] jump and land [] throw [] one-foot balance [] short sprint [] side-step Joints:

Muscle:

Component it trains: _____ Barely touches: _____

2 Four stations, four different components, written before you move.

1

2.

3.

4.

If two of these are both speed, you have built a race and called it a range.

3 Bar on the naming gate: [] 1 [] 2 [] 3 [] 4 [] 5

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap. Watch your partner's movement and fill their line **without** them telling you the station. The interesting disagreement is usually the muscle that did the unspectacular work: the standing leg, the middle, the arm that did not throw.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.3

How hard, and how do you know

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Cones for a loop around the spring, a stopwatch, a clipboard. Work in threes: mover, timer, watcher. Bottles on the dry stone.

○ WARM UP

Walk the loop once and talk the whole way. Then jog it once and keep talking. If the second lap kills the sentence, you have already started this topic, and you started it too fast.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 6.2, name three components that are not speed. _____
 _____ Which one does a long loop
 around the spring actually train? _____

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The spring loop is athletics endurance: a longer go at a pace you can talk at, not a sprint with a nicer name. Pip treats it as a race. By the trough he can say one word, then he is sitting. Bramble starts slower, talks to Tuft in whole sentences, and is still jogging when he gets back. "I won," says Pip. "You finished," says Willow, "and then you could not start the next station. That is not endurance."

► Learn

Intensity is how hard the activity is for **you, today**. It is not how hard it looks from the gatepost. Year 6 judges it with two things together.

How hard it feels. Your heart is a muscle. When you work, it beats faster, and you can feel that in your chest or at the side of your neck. You do not need a count. You need to notice whether it has gone up, and whether it comes back down when you ease off.

The talk test. That is the check you can do while you are still moving.

INTENSITY	TALK TEST	HOW HARD IT FEELS
Easy	you can sing, or talk without thinking about it	warm, not worked
Moderate	you can talk but not sing	heart up, still in control
Vigorous	you can say only a few words without pausing for breath	hard, and short unless that was the plan

A sprint is supposed to be vigorous. A warm-up is not. A stamina loop that you cannot finish because you treated it like a sprint was the wrong intensity, not a weak body.

The rule for this topic. Plan the intensity. Then check it with talking, and with how hard it feels. If those two disagree, believe the talking.

GATE 6.3 • THE INTENSITY GATE

- ① Walk a loop and talk easily the whole way.
- ② Jog at talk-test **moderate**: sentences, not a song, not a gasp.
- ③ Do one short vigorous go, then recover until talking is easy again.
- ④ Plan two different activities, run both, and compare them using the talk test.
- ⑤ Hold the intensity you wrote down for the whole station, while a watcher checks talking.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 is the one that turns a plan into a habit.

► WATCH ME TRY

Bramble plans three goes. Walk: easy, he could have sung. Jog: moderate, sentences, no song. A third go he called moderate: a few words only. He had drifted. He goes back to the second pace and holds it. He did not fail the loop. He failed the **plan**, because the plan said moderate and the talking said vigorous. Next year's PE will keep asking for that honesty, and nobody will be standing there to give it to you.

♦ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Go 2: Bramble talking to Tuft in whole sentences, still jogging. Go 3: two words, then a breath, then two words. He called it moderate and it was not.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

if they cannot say a sentence without pausing for breath, the go is vigorous, whatever they named it before they started.



The talk test, live. Bramble is jogging the spring loop and he is in the middle of a sentence. Tuft is beside him, listening, which is the whole job. Pip is behind, faster, and his mouth is open on a breath rather than a word. Same clay, two intensities.

▣ DID YOU KNOW?

The **talk test** is the check this topic is built on. At **moderate** intensity you can talk but not sing. At **vigorous** intensity you can say only a few words without pausing for breath. Use it while you are moving. A test you can only do after you have stopped is a test that arrived too late.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Three goes. The watcher writes talking, not "good". Walk (easy):

Endurance jog (moderate):

Short sprint (vigorous):

- 2 Compare the jog and the sprint. Which one left you more ready for a **next** station, and how do you know?
- 3 Plan a ten-minute block with at least two intensities, before you move.

Did you hold it? [] held [] drifted faster [] drifted easier, on purpose

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Plan three intensities in one ten-minute block, including a recovery until talking is easy. A watcher who has not seen the plan has to name each intensity from your talking alone. You pass when their list matches the plan.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.4

Assessing a risk before you take it

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

The spring loop as it is today, plus one changed condition your teacher has already checked: wet stone, a slope, a narrower path, or another group sharing the space. **A teacher sets out and tests every marker before you go.**

○ WARM UP

Walk the loop once with your eyes down on the ground, then once with your eyes up. Name one thing that could go wrong today that was not true last lesson.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 6.3, what does the talk test say about vigorous intensity?

From Unit 1, what may a setter never change? _____

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The stones around the trough are wet. The clay path is dry. Pip steps onto the wet stone because it is the shortest line. Tuft will not start at all. "It is wet," he says, as if wet were a full stop. Rowan chalks a new start on the dry clay, one stride to the left. The task is the same task. Nobody is on the wet stone. "That was not brave," says Pip. "That was the work," says Willow.

► Learn

A **risk** is something that could go wrong, in this space, today, with these bodies. It is not a feeling that you are not very good. Year 6 **assesses** before it **takes**. Name the risk, decide what to change, say the change out loud, write it. Then keep watching, because the ground does not promise to stay as it was.

LOOK AT THIS	A RISK IT CAN CARRY	A CHANGE THAT KEEPS THE WORK
surface	wet stone, loose gravel, a slope	move the start, shorten the stride, take the dry line
kit	a cone on its side, a rope in a lap	stand it up, coil it, leave it out
other bodies	two loops, one path	one way only, and a give-way mark
you, today	little sleep, already tired, new task	slower, shorter, a rest built in
weather	sun in the eyes, a sudden wet	change direction, delay, tell an adult

Changing the task is control. Pushing through a new sharp pain is not bravery. Refusing the whole lesson because one stone is wet is not safety either. It is missing the bar.

The rule for this topic. Name the risk. Change one thing. Write it. Then go. Do not invent a second task, and do not pretend the risk was not there.

GATE 6.4 • THE RISK GATE

- ① Name one risk in the space before anybody moves.
- ② Change one thing (route, speed, kit, number of bodies) and say why.
- ③ Write the risk and the change on the sheet, then go.
- ④ Manage a change that appears **while** you are moving, without changing the safety.
- ⑤ Set the risk line for another group, so they can run it from your sheet alone.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 is independence: the next group should not need you standing there.

► WATCH ME TRY

Rowan writes the risk line. *Wet stone around the trough. Two groups, one path.* Change: start cone on the dry clay, one-way loop, give-way mark. Nobody on the wet stone, including to pick up a cone. **Attempt 1.** Pip still cuts the corner. Stop, walk back, start from the dry cone. **Attempt 2.** Pip takes the dry line, loses a second, keeps the loop. The assessment was not the thing that failed on attempt 1. The **taking** failed, because a written change that nobody follows is decoration.

+ STAY SAFE

Stop and tell an adult, and do not test it twice: new sharp pain, dizziness, cannot speak a short sentence, cannot see clearly, a bump to the head, or any wobble in a bench, box or bar. You never move apparatus into place yourself while somebody is using it. The setter may change the task. The setter may never change the safety.



The change is the dry line. Rowan is pointing at a cone on the clay, not at the wet stone by the water. Tuft is waiting on the path with his feet still. Pip has already taken a step towards the trough and is being called back. The stone is dark, which is why the start had to move.

• YOUR TURN

1 Before anybody moves: the risk

the one change

what stays the same

when we would stop and tell

2 Did anybody ignore the change? ☐ no ☐ yes, and we stopped ☐ yes, and we pretended not to see it

3 A second risk appeared while you were moving. What was it, and what did you do?

Bar on the risk gate: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap sheets with another three. Run **their** loop from their risk line only. Then tell them the one line you needed that they did not write. That is why bar 5 exists.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.5

Before, and afterwards

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Six minutes at the start of the lesson, four at the end, in the same space you will use. The spring loop is the place.

○ WARM UP

This topic *is* the warm-up. Take it slowly on purpose. If somebody starts a sprint in minute one, stop the group and begin again.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 6.4, what do you do before you take a risk?

From 6.3, a warm-up should sit at which intensity, and how do you know?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan is asked to lead the warm-up for the spring circuit. He claps. Everybody sprints to the far cone. Two of them pull up. The rest arrive unable to talk, which means the first station has already been spent. "We are warm," says Rowan. "You are tired," says Willow. "Those are different."

► Learn

A **warm-up** gets the body ready. A **cool-down** brings it back. Year 6 names the **parts**, because "just jog a bit" is how people start on a cold ankle. Never stretch a cold muscle as the first thing you do.

PART	WARM-UP	COOL-DOWN
1	Pulse raiser: easy travel, talking still easy, so heart, breathing and temperature rise gradually	Easy travel: walk until talking is easy again, so you do not crash onto a bench
2	Mobility: the joints you will actually use, moved through a comfortable range	Gentle stretch: two or three holds you can still breathe in; flexibility gets its minute warm
3	A little of the skill: two or three easy copies of what comes next, so the brain arrives too	Water, then stop: a drink from your own bottle; you started losing water as soon as you got warm

A throwing lesson and a sprint lesson should not share the same warm-up. The pulse raiser can be similar. The mobility and the skill copies must match the work.

The rule for this topic. Warm up in three parts, cool down in three parts, and be able to say what each part is for. If you cannot name the part, you have not got it.

GATE 6.5 · THE BEFORE-AND-AFTER GATE

- ① Follow a warm-up somebody else leads, all the way through.
- ② Name its three parts out loud as they happen.
- ③ Write a warm-up for a **different** activity, and the two are not the same.
- ④ Lead yours, and a watcher can still talk at the end of it.
- ⑤ Run a cool-down that brings talking back to easy, then two gentle stretches you can breathe in.

Ring the bar you can hold today. If the watcher cannot talk at the end of your warm-up, it was a race.

► WATCH ME TRY

Attempt 1. Sprint to the cone. No pulse raiser, no mobility, no skill copy. Fail.

Attempt 2. Walk the loop, then jog it, then ten ankle rises and ten open hips, then two easy side-steps through the cones. Talking still easy. **Afterwards.** Walk until sentences come back, two gentle stretches (calf against the dry stone, hamstring sitting), water. Nobody sat down first. Attempt 2 is slower to look at and much faster to recover from.

◊ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Attempt 1: a sprint. Two pulled up. Nobody could say a sentence at the cone. Attempt 2: walk, jog, ankles and hips, two easy copies of the agility station. Talking the whole way.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

at the end of a warm-up the mover must still be able to talk in a sentence. If they cannot, the warm-up stole the lesson.



Before the circuit, and not yet a race. The six of them are on the clay in a loose line: walking, swinging arms, ankles working. The spring is behind them and nobody has gone near the wet stone. Rowan is at the front with his mouth open on a word, which is how you know this is still a warm-up.

• YOUR TURN

- 1 Write a warm-up for **today's** main activity. Pulse raiser:

Mobility (joints):

A little of the skill:

- 2 Tick: ☐ three parts, in order ☐ I could still talk ☐ we did not stretch cold ☐ nobody sat down immediately after the hard work
- 3 Two cool-down stretches I can breathe in:

Bar on the before-and-after gate: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

▲ CLIMB A BAR

Write a second warm-up for a **different** lesson. The pulse raiser may be similar. The mobility and the skill copies must not be. A watcher has to say which lesson each one belongs to. If they cannot tell, you wrote the same warm-up twice.

UNIT 6 - TOPIC 6.6

What a moving body needs to eat

■ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

No food in the lesson. A bottle of water each, on the dry stone. Paper and a pencil for a plate you will draw, not eat.

○ WARM UP

Drink water. Sit. Then stand and shake the ankles and wrists. That is all. This is already part of looking after the work.

← DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 6.1, how much sleep do children aged 6 to 12 generally need in 24 hours? _____ From 6.5, when does the bottle come out in a cool-down?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sports afternoon. Pip skipped breakfast, has not drunk since he left the house, and by the second game he has a headache he blames on the other team. Tuft offers him a sip from his own bottle. Willow, without looking up, says: "Water. Your own. And the headache was thirsty, not unfair."

► **Learn**

A moving body needs **regular meals, water, rest** and **sleep**. This page is not a diet, and it is not a list of forbidden snacks. It is what lets the spring loop still be available after lunch.

Water is the drink for a PE lesson. Energy drinks are not for this lesson, and they are not a substitute for last night's sleep. You do not weigh anything. You do not compare plates. You do notice three things: have I drunk, have I eaten something that will last a lesson, am I trying to play on an empty morning or on a huge one.

ON A MOVING-DAY PLATE	WHY THE WORK LIKES IT
bread, rice, pasta, potatoes, oats	energy that lasts a lesson
fruit and vegetables	a body that is moving still needs them
beans, eggs, fish, meat, or another protein food	growing and repairing after the work
a little dairy, or a similar food you actually eat	bones, and it sits well on the same plate
water	you lose it when you get warm

A simple mixed meal is several kinds of food on one plate, not a packet on its own. Sweets can be part of a week. They are not a warm-up.

The rule for this topic. Water, a mixed meal, rest, sleep. Comment on the moving, never on somebody's body.

GATE 6.6 • THE MOVING-DAY GATE

- ① Put a bottle of water where you will actually drink it.
- ② Name a simple mixed meal for a moving day.
- ③ Write drink, food, rest and sleep for one moving day, with no comment on anybody's body.
- ④ Compare two moving days and say which one would leave you more ready.
- ⑤ Help a partner plan theirs. The only advice is about the moving.

Ring the bar you can hold today. Bar 5 fails the moment the advice becomes about them, not about the day.

► WATCH ME TRY

Pip writes two moving days, after the headache. **Day A.** No breakfast. No bottle. PE. A packet at the gate. Cross by game two. **Day B.** Breakfast (oats and fruit). Bottle on the dry stone, sips at the planned stops. Mixed lunch (bread, beans, fruit, water). Sleep the night before in the 9 to 12 hours. Sunday still a rest. Day B is not a better person. It is a better **day**.

+ STAY SAFE

No sharing bottles. No eating while running. If someone feels faint, they sit, they tell an adult, they sip their own water. You do not diagnose them and you do not comment on what they brought to eat.



A moving-day plate, and nothing else. A still life on the dry stone by the spring: a simple mixed meal, a piece of fruit, a bottle of water. No wrapper you could name, no tin that promises extra, no pile of the same food twice. Shade, not full sun. The trough is in the picture and nobody is drinking from it.

▣ **DID YOU KNOW?**

Water is the drink for a PE lesson. That is the whole instruction. Bring it, put it where you will actually drink it, use your own bottle. Energy drinks are not for this lesson.

● **YOUR TURN**

- 1 Tick what is true of **your** next moving day. ☐ I know where my bottle will sit ☐ I can name a mixed meal, not a packet on its own ☐ I have a rest somewhere in the week ☐ sleep is in the plan, not left to luck
- 2 Draw the plate, from above. Several kinds of food, and water.



A MOVING-DAY PLATE, FROM ABOVE

- 3 One change for **my** next long active day (about the day, not a body):

Bar on the moving-day gate: ☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Help your partner plan their moving day. You may ask about the bottle, the meal, the rest and the sleep. You may not comment on what they look like, what they weigh, or what they "should" stop eating. If that sentence feels obvious, good. It is the bar most groups fail when they think they are being kind.

The spring circuit

Six of you, the loop around the water, about thirty-five minutes, and this time the sheet is marked as well as the moving. This is everything from the Hill Spring at once: a warm-up, named components, set intensities, the wet stone assessed, an athletics endurance loop and a circuit, a cool-down, and one goal. You write the morning down first, then you run it without being fed the next instruction.



A circuit the six planned themselves. The spring sits in the middle and the stations sit on the dry clay around it, not on the wet stone. Rowan is at the sheet. Willow is already watching talking, not speed. One long loop is the endurance station, and it is the one that looks the least like a race.

THE SPRING CIRCUIT • THE FIVE STEPS

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
1	Plan it. Day sheet, risk line, warm-up in three parts, six stations named. Before anybody moves.	Could another group run this from the sheet alone?
2	Warm up. Pulse raiser, mobility, a little of the first skill. Talking still easy.	Three parts, in order. Watcher can still hear a sentence.
3	Run it. One endurance loop at moderate, then five stations: agility, speed, coordination, balance, bodyweight strength. Reaction can live inside one of them.	Six different components, not six versions of a sprint. Intensities held.
4	Evaluate. Watcher records talking at the endurance loop and at one other station. You compare them.	Does the talk test match what you planned?

STEP	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT IT IS JUDGED ON
5	Cool down, then a goal. Easy travel, two stretches, water. One written goal for next time, small enough to do.	Talking is easy again. The goal names a component or an intensity, not a wish.

What good looks like: the sheet is still on the dry stone at the end, with pencil on it, and every one of the six can say which bar they were on, and the one thing they will change next time.

Step 1 is the one that gets skipped, and skipping it is how a circuit becomes a race. Flexibility lives in the cool-down, not as a bounced stretch in the middle. Reaction can be a clap-start on the speed station, or a dropped beanbag on coordination.

+ STAY SAFE

An adult has checked every station, including the wet stone, before you set markers. One-way around the spring. Bottles off the path. Stop for the same list as 6.4. The setter may change a station. The setter may never send anybody onto unchecked ground.

Our circuit, written down before we move

OUR SPRING SHEET

MINUTES	PLACE	WHAT HAPPENS THERE	WHO
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____

Risk we can see:

Change:

STATIONS, FROM ABOVE, AROUND THE SPRING

WHAT THE WATCHER HEARD (TALKING)

The goal I set for next time, small enough to do:

♦ WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Sheet: five rows filled, risk line written, warm-up in three parts. Endurance loop planned as moderate. Speed station planned as vigorous and short. Talking: endurance loop was sentences. Speed station was a few words, then they recovered. Goal: "hold moderate on the endurance loop for two full circuits without drifting." That is a goal. "Get fitter" is not.

The criterion I would give somebody else:

a spring sheet passes when every station names a component and an intensity, the risk line is written before the first go, and the goal at the end could be checked in one lesson.

How did the spring go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet. Answer for today, not for your best ever week.

AT THE HILL SPRING

YES / NEARLY
/ NOT YET

I can say why activity matters for health, fitness and wellbeing, and they are not the same word



I sketched a week with moving minutes in it, and a rest, instead of two heroic lessons



AT THE HILL SPRING	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I named joints, a muscle, and the component a movement trains	☐ ☐ ☐
I used how hard it felt and the talk test together, and I believed the talking	☐ ☐ ☐
I planned an intensity and held it, or I noticed that I drifted	☐ ☐ ☐
I assessed a risk before I took it, and I changed one thing	☐ ☐ ☐
I can name the three parts of a warm-up and of a cool-down, and why they are there	☐ ☐ ☐
Water was the drink, and I can name a simple mixed meal for a moving day	☐ ☐ ☐
Our spring sheet could have been run by a group who had never met us	☐ ☐ ☐
I set one goal small enough to check in a single lesson	☐ ☐ ☐

The last two rows are worth as much as the eight about moving. In Year 6 the plan is marked, the goal is written, and the looking-after is yours. Those are the jobs that make the moving worth anything next year, and they are the ones this unit adds.

▪ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ say why physical activity matters for health, fitness and wellbeing
- ☐ sketch a week that averages moving minutes across it, including rest and sleep
- ☐ name joints, muscles and the component of fitness a movement trains
- ☐ use stamina, agility, speed, coordination, balance, bodyweight strength, flexibility and reaction on purpose
- ☐ judge intensity with how hard it feels and the talk test, together
- ☐ plan a range of activities, evaluate them, and compare how hard they were
- ☐ hold a planned intensity, or notice that I drifted and say so
- ☐ assess a risk before I take it, change one thing, and write the change
- ☐ build a warm-up and a cool-down from their real parts, and lead one

- ☐ choose water and a simple mixed meal for a moving day, without commenting on anybody's body
- ☐ plan a simple activity on a sheet another group could run
- ☐ set one short-term goal I can check in a single lesson
- ☐ work with more independence: choose the bar, write the plan, check myself
- ☐ arrive at next year's PE able to look after the work without being told each step

Words we used

The words you needed on the high fields, from the gate to the spring.



Willow, writing it down. She is the reason this book has a word list at all: every one of these words is a word she needed to say exactly what she had seen. Look at how she holds the clipboard, and how still she is.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
repertoire	The whole set of movements you can already perform. Not one skill: all of them.
audit	Checking every part of your repertoire to find out what state it is actually in.
consolidate	To keep a broad range of skills in working order, rather than improving one of them.
skill family	A group of related movements: travelling, leaving the ground, turning, balancing, sending and receiving.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
rusty	A skill you used to do well and have stopped practising. It goes silently, which is the problem.
repair	To bring a rusty skill back, one named detail at a time.
refine	To make a movement you can already do better, in small steps.
sequence	Two or more movements joined so that there is no stop in the middle.
join	The place where one movement becomes the next. Harder when the two movements are unlike.
variety	How many different skill families your movements come from. Judged separately from the joins.
smooth	Nothing goes wrong at the joins. You look at each join to see it.
fluent	The whole sequence has one rhythm, and the rhythm was chosen. You look at the whole thing to see it.
rhythm	The speed you hold between the joins, and how even it is from start to finish.
success criterion	A sentence somebody else can use to judge a movement without you standing there.
deduction	An amount taken off a score for something that went wrong. Gymnastics starts at 10.0 and takes deductions off.
transition	The join between two unlike parts of an event. In a triathlon it is timed and it counts.
adapt	To keep the sequence and change only the one thing that was asked for.
setter	The pupil whose job is to change the task out loud while it is running, and never the safety.
pass into space	A pass that arrives where the runner is going, not where they are standing.
support	Being in a passing lane so a teammate has somewhere to play the ball.
width	Holding the sides of a space so the middle is not crowded.
tactic	A simple plan for a game: where people stand, and what they try first.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
success criterion	A sentence somebody else can use to judge a movement without you standing there.
composition	A short sequence chosen to say something: a mood, a theme, or a story.
dynamic	How a movement is done: fast or slow, strong or light, sudden or sustained.
role	The job you have accepted in a group, including what you must not do.
short-term goal	A next try you can test in this lesson or the next one.
negotiate	To say what you need, hear what they need, and write a deal both can use.
fair play	Following the rules when the score matters, including the restart.
constructive feedback	One thing seen, and one next try. Not good. Not bad.
intensity	How hard a task is. The talk test is how you check it.
moderate	Hard enough to talk but not to sing.
vigorous	Hard enough that you can say only a few words without pausing for breath.
warm-up	The start of a lesson that raises heat and wakes joints before the hard work.
cool-down	The end of a lesson that brings the body back down before you sit still.

The four jobs

JOB	IN ONE LINE
mover	Does the movement, properly, at the bar they said they were on.
timer	Counts or times, and says the real number out loud.
watcher	Looks at one thing, says what they saw, then turns it into a criterion.
setter	Changes the task while it is running. Never the safety.

The three drawings

DRAWING	WHAT IT SHOWS
five-bar gate	One task written four or five times over, each bar harder than the bar below. Ring the bar you can hold.
day sheet	A morning in minutes: which place, what happens there, and who is doing it.
marked ground	The swept clay ground seen from above, with white chalk on it, the way Willow sees it.

Answers for every unit

Some tasks in this unit have one right answer. Most do not, because a movement task is answered with a body and no two bodies answer it the same way. Where there is no single answer, this page says what a good answer must **contain** instead. Teachers can mark from the right-hand column without having seen the lesson.

One thing to watch for throughout: in Year 6 the pupil chooses the bar, so the mark is for **choosing well and reporting honestly**, not for choosing high. A pupil working at bar 2 and saying so has met the objective better than a pupil failing at bar 5 and claiming it.



Two sheets, side by side. Pip is pointing at a line on Bramble's sheet, not on his own. Comparing what you meant with what a watcher wrote is the last step of every task in this unit, and it is the one that turns a morning of moving into something you can carry into next week.

1.1 Keeping a broad range in repair

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, rule 7	Say which bar you are on, out loud, before you go. The second half: changing it quietly halfway through is what the book calls cheating . Accept "lying" or "dishonest" for the second answer, but the pupil must have understood that it is the reporting, not the difficulty, that is at stake.
Practise 1, audit the five families	Five rows completed, one movement per family, with a watcher's description in the middle column. Descriptions must name body parts and what they did. Reject "fine", "bad" and "quite good", which cannot be checked.
Practise 2, which failed earliest	A named skill. Earliest, not worst-feeling: a pupil who names their least favourite skill rather than the one that broke first has not read the task. Accept a disagreement with the watcher if the pupil gives a reason.
Practise 3, name your one detail	Must be about a body part and visible to a watcher: "land on the front of the foot", "keep the raised knee up", "hands still". Reject "do it better", "concentrate", "try harder".
Practise 4, the table of ten goes	Four rows completed, from goes 1, 4, 7 and 10. The watcher's column must describe the one chosen detail each time, not the whole movement. The count is a number. A count that does not fall is a valid result.
Practise 5, which bar	Any bar may be ringed truthfully. Bar 1 is a real answer. What is not acceptable is a ringed bar that the watcher's notes contradict, and that is worth a conversation rather than a mark.
Go a little further, whose families were rusty	No fixed answer. Look for the observation that people stop practising what they were never best at.

1.2 A wider variety, linked

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, the five families	Travelling • leaving the ground • turning • balancing • sending and receiving. All five needed, in any order. Accept "jumping" for leaving the ground and "throwing and catching" for sending and receiving.
Practise 1, tick the families	At least three ticks for bar 3. Check the ticks against the movements in Practise 2: a pupil who ticks three families and then writes four kinds of running has ticked aspirationally.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 2, the four movements in order	Four movements, in performance order, drawn from at least three ticked families, with the family written beside each. Three joins marked.
Practise 3, the weakest join	A named join, 1, 2 or 3, with a reason , for each of the three goes. A pupil who writes the whole sequence again instead of naming the join has not done the task. Look for the weakest join changing across the three goes: fixing one join usually reveals another, and that is progress, not failure.
Practise 4, chalk it from above	Must use the marks correctly: dashed line for the route, ring at the start, dark disc for a held position, short upright mark at each join.
Practise 5, ticks	All four may be true. The fourth, "I could have performed it again immediately", is the strongest evidence, because it means the sequence still had something left at the end.
Climb a bar, two goes told apart	Passed only when a watcher who has not seen it before writes both goes separately and cannot say which description belongs to which.

1.3 Fluency, and how it is judged

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, the two things a sequence is judged on	The joins and the variety . Both needed. Sorrel scored nothing on variety : her four movements were all from the travelling family. A pupil who says she scored nothing on the joins has it backwards, and 1.2 is worth revisiting with them.
Practise 1, time each movement separately	A time for every movement, for three goes. The point of the task is the spread of times, so a pupil who records one total for the whole sequence has missed it.
Practise 2, the shortest movement	A movement number. In most classes it is a leap or a jump, because leaving the ground is the movement that most wants to be fast. Accept any answer that matches the pupil's own Go 1 column.
Practise 3, the rhythm you chose	Any rhythm stated before moving, and specific enough to hold: "count of four for every movement", "slow all the way", "one, two, three, hold". Reject "smooth" and "normal", which are not rhythms.
Practise 4, the half-as-long criterion	Applied correctly to their own Go 3 column: no movement shorter than half the longest. A pupil who fails it and names the failing movement has completed the task correctly.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 5, score your own Go 3	Deductions taken from 10.0. Look for strictness : a pupil who scores 9.9 on a go their watcher described as having a clear pause has not applied the 0.5. There is no target score.
Go a little further, a rhythm you did not choose	Expect it to be worse than their chosen rhythm, and expect the pupil to be surprised by how much. The reason is in the topic: practised adjustments belong to the practised speed.

1.4 Choosing your own task, and adapting live

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, smooth and fluent	Smooth is about the joins. Fluent is about the whole sequence, and its rhythm. Both halves needed.
Practise 1, ring your bar	Any step, written before moving. This is the objective's "self-selected" half, and the choosing is the assessed part.
Practise 2, the three-column table	Three rows. Every row needs something in What I kept . The kept column is the whole test: it is what separates adapting from starting again.
Practise 3, an empty kept column	Correct answer names what should have been kept: the movements, the order, the joins, or the rhythm. A pupil who writes "nothing" has understood the question and should be asked it again after another go.
Practise 4, two movers drawn	Two routes on each plan, one solid and one dashed, with a cross where somebody gave way. The second drawing should show fewer crossings than the first: that is the effect of having talked about it.
Practise 5, ticks	The third tick, "I paid for the change earlier in the sequence", is the Year 6 answer and the one to look for. Reacting at the moment of the call is Year 3. Anticipating the cost is Year 6.
Climb a bar, swap gates	Passed when the pupils perform another group's bar 4 from the written sequence alone, with that group's setter, and can name the one detail they personally had to change.

The day you plan

STEP	WHAT A FINISHED PROJECT LOOKS LIKE
1 Plan it	A day sheet with every row complete : minutes, level, task, names. The test is the one printed on the page: could a group who had never met them run it from the board alone? Boards that fail usually fail by giving a level too few minutes for everybody to take every role once.
2 Audit and repair	Each pupil names a rusty family, not a strong one, and works at a step they chose and stated.
3 Build for variety	Four movements, three or more families, three joins, and a balance held to a count of three. Count the families : this is the step most often claimed and not met.
4 Make it fluent	A rhythm chosen out loud, each movement timed separately, and the half-as-long criterion applied to their own numbers.
5 Run it live	A setter and a second mover. The Keep column full on every go. A group whose sequence collapsed at every call has done bar 5 honestly and should be marked on the honesty and sent back to bar 4.

Marking the plan. Half of this project is the board, and the board is easier to mark than the moving because it is still there at the end of the lesson. If only one thing is marked, mark that.



The tack room, after. Hoops on their pegs, ropes coiled, cones stacked, the ball in its crate. Ground rule 8 says put the equipment back where it came from without being asked, and this is what that looks like when a group has actually done it.

2.1 The words a sport actually uses

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, success criterion	A sentence somebody else can use to judge a movement without you standing there. Accept "a rule a watcher can mark against".
Practise, activity word	Must be an activity word (pass into space, first touch, support, close down, width), not <i>good</i> or <i>nice</i> . More/less must match what they saw.
Gate bar	Any bar may be ringed honestly. A new watcher using three words at bar 5 is the stretch, not the expected floor.

2.2 Action, dynamic, space, relationship

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Four labels	All four named on the same moment: what the body did, how, where, and with whom. Missing one family is not a pass.
Change one	Only one of the four changes. Changing two is a new task, not an adaptation.

2.3 Writing the criteria, then marking against them

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Criterion	Names a body part or a visible decision. Reject "try harder", "concentrate", "be better".
Marking	Ticks and crosses against the written line, not against a feeling.

2.4 Rules, tactics, and having more than one plan

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Plan A and Plan B	Both named before the game. Plan B is used only when Plan A is stopped. A group that never named B has not done the topic.
Offside fact	A player is offside if, when the ball is played, they are in the opponents' half and nearer the goal line than both the ball and the second-last opponent.

3.1 to 3.4 The orchard

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Four situations	The same invention remade for alone, pair, competitive, and cooperative. One situation missing means the topic is not done.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Three answers	Three different solutions to one problem, then one ringed. The ring is the assessed part.
Self-directed task	The problem is written before anybody moves. A pupil who invents while moving has skipped 3.3.
Mood	A watcher who was not told the mood can name it from the movement. If they need the card, the composition has not said it.
Floor time	Women's artistic gymnastics floor has a 90 second maximum.

4.1 to 4.6 The hay meadow

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Four ways	Evidence of working alone, sharing space, in a pair, and in a small group.
Role	The written role includes a forbid: what that person must not do. A role with only a title is not a role.
Goal	Testable in this lesson or the next. Reject "get fitter" and "be better at basketball".
Leading	Helping the next person succeed. Volume is not evidence.
Planning	A written plan before the match. The pencil moving is the pass, not the longest speech.

5.1 to 5.5 The tack room

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Heavy kit	Two people, a spoken "go" and "down", path said first, put away as part of the job.
Deal	Need + limit + written sentence. Winning the hoop is a fail.
Fair play	Decision accepted, game restarted. Argument after the call is the fail, even if the pupil was right.
Help	One specific question, asked at a stop or between goes, not mid-flight.
Hurt	Stop, tell an adult, do not play on.
Feedback	One body part or decision + one next try. "Good" and "bad" are not feedback.

6.1 to 6.6 The hill spring

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
60 minutes	UK Chief Medical Officers: children 5 to 18 average at least 60 minutes of moderate-to-vigorous activity per day across the week .
Talk test	Moderate: can talk, not sing. Vigorous: only a few words without pausing for breath.
Sleep	Ages 6 to 12 generally need 9 to 12 hours in 24 hours.
Drink	Water . Energy drinks are not recommended.
Risk	Named, then changed, before the first go. A risk noticed after somebody slips is too late.
Warm-up	Raises heat and wakes joints. Stretching cold is not a warm-up in this book.
Diet	A mixed plate and water. No brands, no calorie counts, no supplements.

Sources for this book

Every fact in a *Did you know?* panel was checked against the source named here on 2026-08-11. Nothing in this unit is recalled or estimated. The full working ledger, including what was checked and rejected, is in 05-SOURCES-01.md.

TOPIC	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
1.1	Naide Gomes won the world indoor pentathlon in Budapest in 2004 with 4,759 points; a knee injury in 2005 ended her combined events career; she won the world indoor long jump in Valencia in 2008 with 7.00 metres; her best jump of 7.12 metres in Monaco on 29 July 2008 is the Portuguese record	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Naide_Gomes
1.2	Olympic-distance triathlon is a 1.5 km swim, a 40 km ride and a 10 km run; the event is timed in five sequential sections; the time spent in transition is a timed segment and contributes towards the overall finishing time	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Triathlon

TOPIC	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
1.2	World Triathlon publishes T1 and T2 as their own result columns	developers.triathlon.org/reference/program-results
1.3	The gymnastics D score pays Composition Requirements of 0.5 per required element group up to 2.00, and Connection Value for linking elements; the E score starts at 10.0 with deductions of 0.1, 0.3, 0.5 and 1.0 for a fall; a pause between skills meant to be connected loses connection value	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Code_of_Points_(gymnastics)
1.4	Futsal is five a side on court including the goalkeeper, on a 40 by 20 metre pitch, two periods of 20 minutes with the clock stopped at every dead ball, and unlimited substitutions permitted while the ball is in play	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Futsal
1.4	Portugal won the 2021 FIFA Futsal World Cup in Lithuania, beating Argentina by 2 goals to 1, their first title	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/2021_FIFA_Futsal_World_Cup
2.4	In 11-a-side football a player is offside if, at the moment the ball is played by a teammate, they are in the opponents' half and nearer the opponents' goal line than both the ball and the second-last opponent	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Offside_(association_football)
2.4	Indoor volleyball is rally scored. A set is won by the first team to 25 points, who must win by two. A deciding fifth set is to 15, still win by two	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Volleyball
3.4	Women's artistic gymnastics floor exercises have a maximum time of 90 seconds	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Floor_(gymnastics)

TOPIC	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
3.2	Rudolf Laban described movement through body, space, dynamics or effort, and relationships	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Laban_movement_analysis
3.1	The corridinho is a traditional circling folk dance from the Algarve	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Corridinho
4.2	Basketball is five a side. The hoop is 3.05 metres (10 feet) above the floor	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Basketball
4.2	Outdoor handball is seven a side including the goalkeeper	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Handball
6.1	UK Chief Medical Officers: children and young people aged 5 to 18 should average at least 60 minutes of moderate-to-vigorous physical activity per day across the week	nhs.uk/live-well/exercise/physical-activity-guidelines-children-and-young-people/
6.3	Talk test: moderate intensity, you can talk but not sing; vigorous intensity, you can say only a few words without pausing for breath	cdc.gov/physicalactivity-basics/measuring/index.html
6.1	Children aged 6 to 12 generally need 9 to 12 hours of sleep in 24 hours	aap.org/en/patient-care/sleep / CDC sleep duration recommendations

Square code destinations

Both addresses were opened and read on 2026-08-11, and both printed codes were decoded off the image to confirm they resolve to exactly these addresses. Neither needs an account and neither charges.

CODE	DESTINATION	WHAT IS THERE
1.1	nhs.uk/live-well/exercise/physical-activity-guidelines-children-and-young-people/	The National Health Service guideline for ages 5 to 18: at least 60 minutes a day of moderate or vigorous activity across the week, spent on a variety of types and intensities of activity to develop movement skills, muscles and bones.

CODE	DESTINATION	WHAT IS THERE
1.2	events.triathlon.org/wtcs/results	World Triathlon's free public results search for the Championship Series, in which the swim, ride and run each carry a time and so do T1 and T2.

For teachers

What this book is for

All six Year 6 units from PDF/Input/Student Book/Y6 Physical Education - Student Book.xlsx: Moving Well, Understanding Movement, Moving Creatively, Taking Part, Taking Responsibility and Healthy Bodies. All 29 scheme objectives are in the manuscript.

Year 6 is the last primary book in the line. It consolidates Years 1 to 5 and prepares pupils for more independence in lower secondary, without becoming a Year 7 textbook.

One thing you should know before you teach it

The Year 6 scheme of work in Input is word for word identical to the Year 5 scheme.

All 29 objectives, all six units, character for character. That was measured off both files on 2026-08-11 and it is recorded in 06-SCHEME-MAP.md with the comparison table.

So this book cannot differentiate from Year 5 on objectives, because there is no difference to work from. It differentiates on **demand, autonomy and variety** instead, and the specific choices are these:

	YEAR 5	YEAR 6, THIS UNIT
What is practised	one movement, refined	a broad range , audited and repaired
Sequence	three movements, two joins	four movements, three families, three joins, held finish
Who sets the task	the book or the teacher	the pupil , from a gate, out loud
Adapting to	apparatus and a setter	a setter and another body , at the same time
Judged on	smoothness	fluency , timed, against a criterion

If your school issues a genuinely different Year 6 scheme, this unit will need rewriting against it, and the place to start is 06-SCHEME-MAP.md.

The pedagogical spine

The unit rests on two moves.

The gate. Every substantial task is written four or five times over, each version harder than the one below. The pupil chooses. This is not differentiation-by-worksheet: it is the scheme's own word, *self-selected*, made into a routine, and it means a class of mixed ability works on one task rather than three.

The four jobs, rotating. Mover, timer, watcher and setter, as in Year 5. The watcher's job grows this year: it is no longer enough to describe a movement accurately, they must turn the description into a success criterion another pupil could apply. That is objective 2.3 in embryo, and it is deliberately started here.

Groups of three are therefore not a suggestion for topics 1.1 to 1.3, and topic 1.4 needs four, because it adds a second mover.



Walking back down at the end of the day. The kit has been shared out differently from the way it came up, which happens by itself when a group has spent a morning taking turns at four jobs. Willow is out in front, still watching.

Timing

Four topics and the project fill about six or seven lessons of 45 minutes for most classes. Topic 1.1 needs a full lesson to itself: the audit takes longer than teachers expect, and cutting it removes the evidence the rest of the unit depends on. Topic 1.3 needs a stopwatch per group and will not work without one, because its entire argument rests on timing each movement separately.

Assessment

Assess from the *Look what I can do* list, the *How did it go?* rings, and the project's day sheet. Not from the times.

Two specific warnings.

- **Do not reward a high bar.** A pupil at bar 2 who says so, works at bar 3 and reports where it fails has met 1.4 better than a pupil failing at bar 5. Rule 7 in *Getting set up* exists to protect that, and it only works if the marking backs it.
- **Mark the plan.** Half of the project is the board, and the board is the part that is still on the floor at the end of the lesson. If you only mark one thing, mark that.

Adaptations

- **Distances, heights, weights and timings are all adjustable.** The objective is control, not size. Shorten the run, lower the apparatus, reduce the count.
- **The gate is the adaptation.** A pupil who needs an easier task takes a lower bar on the same gate, which means they are doing the same lesson as everybody else rather than a different one. That is the whole reason the book is built this way.
- **A pupil who cannot travel** takes the same four families into seated or supported movement: an arm pathway can be fast, slow, high, low, large, small, strong or light, can be linked to a turn of the head or a reach, and can be timed for fluency exactly as a run can. The five families become four; say so rather than pretending otherwise.
- **A pupil who cannot write** dictates the watcher's description and the criterion to a partner, or draws the marked ground instead. The criterion matters; the handwriting does not.
- **Apparatus is set out and tested by an adult**, always. The violet *Stay safe* panel in 1.4 is written to the pupil, but the responsibility is the teacher's, and 1.4 is the topic in this unit where two movers share one space.

PRIME BOOKS

Physical Education

Year 6 · Cambridge Primary · Student Manual

The finish field.

The last year of primary physical education: healthy bodies, joints and muscles, how hard is hard enough, reading the risk before you go, and what a moving body eats.

INSIDE THIS BOOK

- Six units, from fitness to the finish field
- The rule of the game, printed on every topic
- A decision to make, with no answer printed
- How did it go? review in every unit
- A whole tournament to finish

Prime Books · Physical Education

Ages 10–11 · Upper Primary

primeschool.pt